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Upskilling Roadmap and Feedback

From SPM on internal tooling to Senior PM / AI PM with real depth

CV feedback | Pilot project review | AI at work | 16-week plan | Interview prep

Prepared for	Vishal Ravi Prabhakar, Senior Product Manager, Silq
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Target lanes	Senior PM (logistics / B2B platforms) and AI PM

Before you start

A note from me, and how to use this document

Vishal,

Thanks for being so honest on our call on Thursday. Most people in your spot dress it up. You didn't. You said two things very plainly: your AI exposure at work is "almost close to none", and you worry you are doing more project management than product management. You also said something I want to hold on to, because the whole document is built around it: you are "shifting with the tide of what comes in as gospel from the management or from the business."

I've now gone through your CV, both GitHub repos (logistics-pm and Co-Pilot-build-v1), and my notes from the call. This document is the note I promised you. It is long on purpose. You should be able to open it on any Monday for the next four months and know exactly what to do that week without needing to message me.

Here is my honest read in one paragraph, so you have it up front. Your problem is not skill. You have more real product substance than most SPMs I speak to: a 0-to-1 quotation engine with a validated hypothesis, a credit product that took client exposure from USD 1.8M to 1.2M, and a finance background that most logistics PMs would kill for. Your problem is **evidence and story**. The work you do reads as "business asked, I delivered", because you have not been instrumenting it, deciding against anything, or writing it down as product decisions. And your AI work is real but sits entirely outside your job, so a hiring manager sees it as a hobby, not experience. Both of these are fixable in about 16 weeks, and the fix for both starts inside Silq, not outside it.

> **The one idea I want you to take from this document:** you don't need a new job to start becoming the PM you want to be. You need 12 weeks of doing your current job differently, so that when you do move (and you should move), you walk in with two SPM-grade stories and one AI-in-production story instead of a side project.

How this document is organised

Part	What it covers	When to read it
1. Where you actually stand	My honest diagnosis of the two concerns you raised, and the concern you didn't raise	Read first, this week
2. CV feedback	Line-by-line feedback, and why the two new CV versions look the way they do	This week
3. Pilot project review	What works in your two repos, what will hurt you, and the fix list	This week, fixes in Week 1
4. Positioning	Who you are in the market, your headline, your 30-second pitch	Week 1 to 2
5. Target role map	Which companies and roles, fit scores, tiers, and the levelling trap	Week 2
6. Getting AI into your day job	The rate-sheet ingestion play at Silq, with a full pitch and PRD outline	Weeks 1 to 10

Part	What it covers	When to read it
7. Building product muscle at Silq	How to turn internal tools into a real product with metrics and decisions	Weeks 1 to 12
8. AI upskilling curriculum	What to learn, in what order, with exercises tied to your work	Weeks 1 to 12
9. Proof of work plan	Four projects, with claim stories, CV bullets and LinkedIn angles	Weeks 1 to 14
10. The 16-week plan	Week-by-week actions across all tracks	Every Monday
11. Interview prep	Story bank with full STAR answers, SPM and AI PM question banks	Weeks 6 to 16
12. Applications and outreach	Where to apply, when, and exact outreach messages	Weeks 5 to 16
13. Rhythm, tracker, and what I review	Your weekly schedule, scorecard and my three review points	Keep open

Three rules for using this

1. **Do the week, not the document.** Don't read all 40 pages and then feel overwhelmed. Read Parts 1 to 5 once. After that, live in Part 10 and open the other parts when a week points you there.
2. **Everything you build gets written up and posted.** If you build something and don't write it up, it did not happen as far as the market is concerned. This is the single biggest gap in your current repos.
3. **Nothing waits for my approval except three things.** I review your CV v1, your AI capstone write-up, and your first two or three mock answers. Everything else, you move on your own. Use the weekend sessions and peer mocks for the rest.

Part 1. Where you actually stand

An honest diagnosis of what you told me, and what you didn't

What you said on the call

You named two concerns and one market worry. I'm writing them down in your words so we're working on the same problem:

- **AI exposure:** "On the AI front, my exposure work-wise is very limited, and very, I mean, almost close to none."
- **Project vs product:** "I am shifting with the tide of what comes in as gospel from the management or from the business... if I'm doing more project management work rather than product management."
- **Market worry:** "I just got promoted to SPM, and I don't really have a lot of AI at work under my belt to show for it." And, if you pivot to mature logistics companies ("MS Dynamics, Flexport type"), "do I not have enough on my experience belt to show for it?"

I told you on the call that the honest long-term answer is to move out. I still think that. But I want to be more precise now that I have seen your work, because "move out" on its own is incomplete advice, and following it too literally is the most expensive mistake you could make in the next six months.

Concern 1: "I'm doing project management, not product management"

Here's the thing. You are partly right and partly wrong, and the part where you are wrong is the one that matters most for your job search.

Where you are right. In a sales-driven freight business, the roadmap mostly arrives as a list of business P0s. You don't pick the problem; you pick how to solve it. You described this exactly: "I have autonomy, full autonomy of solving that entire thing on my own... but still somewhere I don't feel like this is what a truer sense of product management is." You're also right that you are not building GTM, funnel or retention muscle, because your "customers" are mostly internal teams and clients who don't pay for the software.

Where you are wrong. Look at your own CV. On the Smart Quotation Engine, you wrote: "Validated the hypothesis that faster quoting drives higher conversion than lower pricing alone." That is not project management. That is a product insight about what drives win rate in freight, and it changed what the company should build next. On the credit product, you chose webhooks plus a daily CDC job because you had seen events go missing. That is a product and systems trade-off. A project manager does not make either of those calls.

So the real gap is not that you do project work. The gap is three specific product behaviours that your environment doesn't force you to do, so you've stopped doing them:

Product behaviour	What it looks like at Silq today	What it should look like
Measuring usage and outcomes of what you ship	You measure the business result (TAT, revenue, exposure) once, at launch	You track a funnel every week: RFQs in, quotes out, time to quote, win rate, by rep and by lane

Product behaviour	What it looks like at Silq today	What it should look like
Choosing what not to build	Business priority comes in, you build it well	You write a one-page case for or against each big ask, and at least once a quarter you change or kill something with data
Treating internal users as customers	Sales and ops use what you ship because they have to	You run discovery with reps and ops, you know your adoption and workaround rates, you know your power users by name

None of these need permission. None need a new job. And every one of them produces interview stories that senior PM loops look for. Part 7 turns this into a 12-week plan.

> **The non-obvious point:** internal platform PM is a real, respected track. Flipkart, Swiggy, Zepto, Delhivery and Razorpay all have PMs who own internal tools for sales, ops and finance. Those PMs get hired into senior roles all the time. What separates them from "project managers with a PM title" is not the type of product. It is whether they can show adoption numbers, trade-offs and a point of view. You are one habit change away from that.

Concern 2: "I have almost no AI exposure at work"

True today. But look closely at what you told me you're already working on at Silq, in your own CV under current projects:

- "Complete overhaul and automation of rate ingestion from vendor rate sheets"
- "Pod-level Kanban dashboards with LLM-guided prioritization to assist sales workload distribution"

The first one is one of the best AI use cases in the whole freight industry, and you already own it. Vendor rate sheets are messy Excel files and PDFs with different layouts per carrier and per agent, surcharges hidden in notes, validity dates in odd formats. Turning those into clean rate master entries is exactly the kind of structured extraction problem LLMs have become good at, and it needs exactly the kind of evaluation discipline you've been teaching yourself on the side.

If you design that rate ingestion overhaul as an LLM extraction pipeline with a proper eval set, human review for low-confidence rows, and a measured accuracy and time-saved number, then in 10 to 12 weeks you stop saying "I have no AI at work" and start saying "I shipped an LLM extraction pipeline into production for rate ingestion, here's the accuracy, here's how I evaluated it, here's what broke." That is a completely different candidate. Part 6 gives you the full pitch to your CTO and the PRD outline.

> **Why this matters more than another side project:** AI PM hiring managers can smell the difference between "I built a RAG tool for myself" and "I shipped an LLM feature to real users who complained when it got things wrong." Your side projects prove you can build. Only a production feature proves you can own AI quality with real users. You have a chance to get both.

The concern you didn't raise (but should)

You said you "just got promoted to SPM" and worry this weakens your market position. It's actually the opposite problem, and it's worth being clear-eyed about.

You have about 4 years 9 months in product (Dec 2021 to now), of which roughly 3 months to a year at SPM level depending on when the promotion landed. Mature companies like Microsoft, Flexport or project44 level on scope and years. There is a real chance they will level you at PM (or PM II) rather than Senior PM, especially in the US-headquartered ones. That is not a failure. For a move into a mature org with better product practice, taking a PM II title at a much stronger company is often the right trade, and you'll get back to Senior within 12 to 18 months with far better stories.

The trap is the opposite: holding out for the SPM title and ending up at a company that is just as sales-driven as Silq, but bigger. That would solve your title problem and leave both of your real problems untouched.

> **My recommendation:** decide now, before you're in a process, what you will and won't accept. My suggestion: SPM at a product-led logistics or B2B SaaS company, or PM II / PM at a mature platform company with a clear path to Senior within 18 months. Don't take SPM at another services business where software is a cost centre. We'll use this as a filter in Part 5.

The second-order risk of leaving too fast

If you started applying aggressively next week, you'd probably get interviews. Your CV has real numbers. But look at what happens in the loop. A hiring manager at a product-led company asks "Tell me about a time you decided not to build something the business wanted" or "How did you measure adoption of your quoting engine after launch?" or "Tell me about an AI feature you shipped and how you evaluated it." Today you'd struggle on all three, not because you're weak, but because you haven't lived those stories yet in a form you can tell.

So the plan is sequenced on purpose:

Phase	Weeks	What you do	Why
Fix and position	1 to 3	Fix repos, finalise CVs, pitch the AI rate-ingestion project at Silq, instrument the quoting funnel	Removes the risks, starts the two stories that need time
Build the stories	4 to 10	Ship the AI rate-ingestion pilot, run one data-led decision at Silq, finish the capstone write-up, light applications to calibrate	Creates the evidence you are missing
Go to market	8 to 16	Full application push, outreach, referrals, interviews	You now have stories nobody else in your pool has

Applications start in Week 5, not Week 16. We start light, to learn from real rejections, and scale once the stories are ready. Don't hide behind prep.

Your real assets (don't undersell these)

Before we get into what to fix, here's what you walk in with. I want you to say these out loud without apologising for them.

1. **Rare domain depth.** Freight forwarding, supply chain OMS and trade finance. Very few PMs in India understand both the physical flow of goods and the money flow (letters of credit, credit limits, A/R, invoicing). You've done both at Zetwerk and at Silq.
2. **Hard numbers from real launches.** 24 hours to under 4.5 hours quote TAT. Conversion from 65% to 78%. About USD 325K a month in added sales revenue. Credit exposure from USD 1.8M to 1.2M in four months. 85%+ credit compliance. INR 240 Cr a month of LCs through a module you built. Most SPM CVs I see have half this.
3. **Finance and modelling depth.** Three years at Deloitte building calculation engines for Goldman Sachs and Burberry. When a pricing, credit or unit-economics question comes up in an interview, you can go deeper than almost any other PM in the room.
4. **You can actually build.** A RAG CLI with ChromaDB, integrations with Linear, Jira and Confluence, 13 tests, and a Claude plugin. Most "AI PMs" on LinkedIn have a Lovable link and nothing behind it.
5. **Leadership signal.** Sole SPM partnering with the CTO and co-founder. A pod of five engineers and a designer. Your APM just got promoted to PM under you. That last one is a great story, and you didn't mention it on your CV.

This roadmap is built around those five things. We lean into the domain, fix the evidence gap, and get AI into your day job.

Part 2. CV feedback

Line-by-line, plus how to use the two new versions

I've already sent you two rewritten CVs in Ayuda format: one for Senior PM roles and one for AI PM roles. This part explains the reasoning, so you can keep editing them yourself and tailor them per JD without losing what makes them work.

The big picture on your current CV

Your current CV has strong raw material and three structural problems.

Problem 1: the summary leads with the wrong thing. It opens with "a unique blend of product expertise and financial modeling capabilities." A recruiter scanning for a Senior PM reads "financial modelling" in the first line and files you as a finance person who moved into product. Your finance depth is an asset, but it's a supporting asset. The lead should be what you own today.

Problem 2: "SPM with 8 years of experience" will get challenged. You have about 4 years 9 months in product and about 3 years 9 months at Deloitte. An interviewer will do that maths in the first five minutes, and you don't want your first answer in the loop to be a correction. Say "8 years, 5 in product." It's honest and it still reads senior.

Problem 3: bullets show what was built, not what you decided. Most of your bullets describe a system ("Implemented live webhooks for real time visibility and daily CDC job to catch missed events"). Senior PM CVs show judgment: what you chose, what you rejected, what you learned. The best line on your CV is the one about validating that speed beats price, and it's buried as a sub-bullet.

There are also small errors that cost more than they seem. Recruiters read typos as carelessness, and you're applying for a role where attention to detail is the job:

Where	Issue	Fix
Zetwerk, LC bullet	"wasmaintained" (missing space)	Rewritten entirely in new version
Silq, API rate bullet	"during quoting .Expired rates" (space before full stop)	Rewritten
Silq, API rate bullet	"c.6- 10 hours"	Use "6 to 10 hrs"
Skills	"Product-led growth,Stakeholder" (missing space)	Skills section rebuilt
Headline	"AI Native builder" (odd capitals)	Removed from headline, shown through bullets
Silq, rate bullet vs GitHub	CV says Shipco, logistics-pm repo PRD says Xeneta	New CV says "third-party rate API". Fix the repo too
Silq, title	"(promoted from Product Manager)" in title line takes space	Promotion moved to the italic one-liner

Summary: old vs new

Version	Text
Old	SPM with 8 years of experience bringing a unique blend of product expertise and financial modeling capabilities owning a B2B freight operating system end-to-end. Proven track record of leading 0–1 products... Using a personalized agentic stack to accelerate the product lifecycle.
New (SPM)	Senior Product Manager with 8 years across B2B platforms, logistics, and trade finance, 5 of them in product. Owns a US freight forwarder's operating system end to end as sole SPM partnering with the CTO. Built a 0-to-1 quotation engine that cut quote TAT from 24 hrs to under 4.5 hrs, lifted conversion from 65% to 78%, and added about USD 325K in monthly revenue. Pairs finance depth with an AI-native build workflow; targeting Senior PM roles in B2B SaaS, logistics tech, and fintech.
New (AI PM)	AI-native Senior Product Manager... Builds decision systems on messy operational data... Ships own AI tooling (RAG pipelines, Claude plugins, MCP integrations, eval rubrics)... Targeting AI PM and Senior PM roles building vertical AI for B2B workflows.

Why the new version works: line one is identity plus years plus domain. Line two is scope (sole SPM, CTO). Line three is the single best proof with before and after numbers. Line four is the ambition. "Proven track record" and "unique blend" are gone because every CV says them and nobody believes them.

Silq bullets: old vs new

Old	New	What changed and why
Smart Quotation Engine: Built 0-1 quotation engine, converting incoming RFQs with a pricing engine... Impact: Reduced sales' average quoting TAT from ~24 hours to under 4.5 hours, Sales revenue increase of c.325K USD per month, and improved quote conversion from 65% to 78%.	Cut quote TAT from ~24 hrs to under 4.5 hrs and lifted quote conversion from 65% to 78% by building a 0-to-1 quotation engine (rate masters, lane pricing, dynamic transit times), adding ~USD 325K in monthly sales revenue.	Outcome first. Three sub-bullets collapsed into one line a recruiter reads in four seconds.
(sub-bullet) Validated the hypothesis that faster quoting drives higher conversion than lower pricing alone.	Validated through quote-level data that speed of response, not lower pricing, drove win rate, shifting the quoting roadmap from discount levers to TAT and pricing accuracy.	Promoted to its own bullet. This is your best judgment signal. Add how the roadmap changed as a result.
Freight trade credit & invoicing: Shipped live QuickBooks synced credit limits vs. shipment exposure... Implemented live webhooks... daily CDC job...	Reduced client credit exposure from USD 1.8M to 1.2M in 4 months by shipping QuickBooks-synced credit limits against live shipment exposure, lifting credit-term compliance to 85%+.	Result leads. The webhook plus CDC detail becomes its own bullet about a design decision.
(inside credit bullet) Implemented live webhooks for real time visibility and daily CDC job...	Designed a webhook plus daily CDC reconciliation layer for invoice and credit data, catching missed events and bringing credit-position drift between systems to zero.	Framed as a design choice. Check the "zero drift" claim. If it's "near zero" or you have a number, use that.

Old	New	What changed and why
API rate automation... Cut rate chase for lanes lacking internal rates from c.6-10 hours to under 1 hour...	Automated lowest-rate benchmarking via a third-party rate API on every RFQ, cutting rate chase on uncovered lanes from 6 to 10 hrs to under 1 hr for Procurement and Account Management.	Tighter. Provider name removed to fix the Shipco and Xeneta mismatch.
AI-accelerated delivery: Utilize a personalized agentic stack... to turbocharge discovery...	SPM version: cut. AI PM version: Cut PRD-to-dev-ready time by ~35% with an agentic stack (repo-aware agents, MCPs, RAG doc generation).	"Turbocharge" is a claim. A number is evidence. The 35% is a placeholder. Measure it (Part 7 shows how).
Current projects: Pod-level Kanban dashboards with LLM-guided prioritization...; overhaul of rate ingestion...; in-app product tours...	AI PM version only: Leading LLM-guided workload prioritization for sales pods and automated ingestion of vendor rate sheets...	Don't list "current projects" as a to-do list. Once the rate-ingestion pilot ships (Part 6), replace this with a real outcome bullet.
Product Leadership & Scope + Team Leadership (two bullets)	Own 6 modules from RFQ to invoicing as sole SPM, leading 5 engineers and 1 designer, mentoring an APM, and aligning Sales, Finance, Ops, and Procurement on one roadmap.	Two bullets merged. Add this once it's true on paper: "mentored APM through promotion to PM".

Zetwerk bullets: the biggest gap

Your Zetwerk section shows scale (INR 240 Cr a month in LCs, INR 60 Cr of inventory) but zero outcomes. Scale tells me what you touched. Outcomes tell me what changed because you were there. In the new CVs I've added placeholder outcomes so you can see the shape. **These are placeholders. Replace them with real numbers or remove them.** Do not walk into an interview with a number you can't explain.

Placeholder in new CV	What to go and find	If you can't find it
LC approval cycle cut from ~5 days to 2	Ask an old Zetwerk finance or ops colleague how long LC approvals took before and after	Use a qualitative outcome: "replacing email and Excel approvals across 8 BUs"
Inventory mismatches down ~30%	Any before and after on stock reconciliation, write-offs or audit findings	"Gave procurement and finance one view of INR 60 Cr of stock for the first time"
Apparel DSO down ~12 days	Collections module usage, overdue % or DSO trend	Use collections coverage: "tracking X% of apparel receivables"
Supplier match rate up ~20% (AI PM version)	Recommendation engine adoption or conversion	Describe the approach and scale instead

Message two old Zetwerk colleagues this week. People are usually happy to help, and "do you remember roughly how long LC approvals used to take?" is an easy question to answer.

Deloitte: keep it short

Two lines is right for a role that ended five years ago and isn't product. Keep the Goldman Sachs and Burberry names because they're credibility shortcuts. Keep the IFRS 16 and NPL deals because they back up your finance depth. Cut everything else.

Sections I removed and why

- **Awards section:** ZetStar moved into the Zetwerk section, Deloitte awards into the Deloitte line. A separate awards section for three items wastes vertical space.
- **Long skills list:** "Product strategy, roadmapping, OKRs, stakeholder management" says nothing. Skills should be the things a recruiter keyword-searches: SQL, Metabase, Mixpanel, RAG, MCP, eval design.
- **The two-line "Built to close a real gap" explanation of your repos:** moved into one tight project bullet with a result.

Which CV goes where

Role type	CV version	What to tweak per JD
Senior PM at logistics tech (Shiprocket, Delhivery, Locus, FarEye, project44 type)	SPM	Mirror their language: "shipper", "carrier", "TMS", "visibility". Put the rate benchmarking bullet higher if they're a rates or procurement product
Senior PM at B2B SaaS / fintech (credit, invoicing, AP/AR)	SPM	Move the credit exposure bullet to position one. Add FinOps terms
PM / PM II at mature platform (Microsoft Dynamics 365 SCM, SAP, Oracle SCM, Blue Yonder, o9)	SPM	Stress integration and data-layer work: ERP sync, Item Master, CDC
AI PM, vertical AI for ops / supply chain	AI PM	Once the Silq pilot ships, the rate-ingestion bullet becomes the first bullet at Silq
AI PM at horizontal AI tooling or developer tools	AI PM	Lead with the builds section. Expect a take-home

> **After every application:** Atlas can tailor the CV to the JD. Use it, but check that it doesn't invent numbers or swap your specific domain words for generic ones. Your domain words are your advantage.

Your LinkedIn: three changes

1. **Headline.** Change to: "Senior PM, freight and B2B platforms | Building AI for logistics ops | ex-Zetwerk, ex-Deloitte". It's searchable and tells people what you're becoming.
2. **About section.** Five short lines: what you own at Silq, your best result, the speed-beats-price insight, what you're building in AI, what you want next. No "passionate about".
3. **Featured section.** Pin three things: the co-pilot write-up (once you post it, Week 3), the plugin write-up (Week 5), and the rate-ingestion case study (Week 11, keeping it anonymised).

Part 3. Pilot project review

What works in your two repos, what will hurt you, and the fix list

On the call you said you wanted to "get a feel of what is required, how I would go about evaluating its outputs against what inputs." That instinct is exactly right, and it's also where the repos are thinnest today. Let's go repo by repo.

Repo 1: Co-Pilot-build-v1 (PM Co-pilot, RAG CLI)

What's genuinely good

- **The problem is real and yours.** You started from your own pain: AI output that sounded "cookie-cutter type, generic, in its own voice." That's the best kind of portfolio problem, because you can talk about it with total authority.
- **The design decisions section is the strongest part of the repo.** "RAG over fine-tuning because it works with 2 to 3 reference docs", "opt-in eval because every eval is an API call", "CLI first to validate the pipeline before investing in UI." Those are product trade-offs, written like a PM. Most portfolio repos have none.
- **Scope beyond a demo.** Doc-type filtering in ChromaDB, Linear, Jira and Confluence integrations, Excalidraw output, prototype generation, and 13 pytest tests. This proves you can actually build.
- **A disclaimer about sample data.** Good. The plugin repo needs the same (see below).

What will hurt you

Issue	Why it hurts	Fix	Time
The `venv/` folder is committed to the repo	Any engineer or technical hiring manager who opens the repo sees it in two seconds. It signals "doesn't know git basics" and undercuts everything else	Delete it, add `venv/` to `.gitignore`, commit	10 min
Setup instructions are Windows-only (`venv\Scripts\activate`, `copy`)	Most reviewers are on Mac or Linux. If they can't run it in two minutes, they stop	Add Mac/Linux commands next to the Windows ones	10 min
No demo	Nobody will clone and run a CLI to evaluate you	Record a 60 to 90 second GIF or Loom: ingest, generate, eval score. Put it at the top of the README	1 hr
No results from the eval you built	You built a 5-dimension rubric but show no scores. This is your best AI PM proof and it's invisible	Add a "Results" section: RAG vs no-RAG scores across 10 topics (see the eval plan below)	4 to 6 hrs
No evidence anyone used it	"I built it for myself" is fine, but one real user makes it a product	Get your APM and one PM friend to use it for two weeks. Capture what they kept vs rewrote	2 weeks elapsed

Issue	Why it hurts	Fix	Time
Name "Co-Pilot-build-v1"	Reads like a folder name, not a product	Rename to something like `pm-copilot` and give it a one-line tagline	5 min

Repo 2: logistics-pm (Claude plugin)

What's genuinely good

- **The domain knowledge section is excellent.** "An RFQ response going out sooner means higher acceptance", surcharge stacking (BAF, CAF, THC), ISF fines, demurrage accruing daily. This is exactly the kind of vertical knowledge that makes generic AI fail and vertical AI win. It's also a perfect interview talking point for "why vertical AI?"
- **The eval framework weights domain accuracy highest.** That shows you understand where AI actually breaks in your domain. That's a senior-level insight.
- **The comparison table vs generic PM plugins** is clear product positioning.

The one urgent issue

> **Fix this before you send your CV to anyone.** The README says the reference-docs folder contains "Two real freight forwarding PRDs (client credit limit with QuickBooks integration, Xeneta rate benchmarking for RFQ quoting)." Those map directly onto features you built at Silq, where you still work. Even if you sanitised them, the README says "real", and a hiring manager will read that as "this person published their employer's PRDs." In a mature company that is a trust question, and trust questions end processes quietly.
>
> Do this today: check both PRDs line by line. Remove anything that is Silq-specific (client names, real numbers, internal system names, vendor contract details). Then change the README wording to "two sample PRDs based on common freight forwarding patterns, fully anonymised" and add the same disclaimer you have in the Co-pilot repo. If you have any doubt, replace them with PRDs you write from scratch for a fictional forwarder. It'll take you two evenings and it removes the risk completely.

Other fixes

Issue	Fix	Time
Shipco on CV, Xeneta in repo	Pick the neutral term "third-party rate provider" in both places, or make them match	10 min
No example output	Add one full example: the input feature line, the generated PRD, the eval scorecard	2 hrs
No before/after vs a generic plugin	Run the same 5 prompts through a generic PM plugin and yours. Show the scores side by side. This is your single most persuasive artifact	4 hrs
Two repos that look like duplicates	Add a line at the top of each README: "v1 was a CLI to validate the pipeline; v2 packages the same idea as a Claude plugin with domain knowledge." Now it's a product evolution story, not two similar projects	15 min

Issue	Fix	Time
0 stars, no LinkedIn link	Post the write-up (Week 3 and Week 5), link the repo, ask five peers to try it	Part of LinkedIn plan

The eval you should run (this is what turns a hobby into AI PM proof)

On the call you said you have "an okay grip on how to measure non-deterministic outputs as opposed to deterministic outputs." Prove it with a small, clean eval. Here's the design. It should take you two weekends.

Step 1: build a golden set

Write 10 feature prompts that span your domain and difficulty. For example:

#	Feature prompt	Why it's in the set
1	Credit limit enforcement for B2B shippers	Finance plus integration, you know the right answer cold
2	Demurrage and detention alerting	Domain-heavy, generic tools miss the economics
3	RFQ auto-triage by lane and mode	Core forwarding workflow
4	Customer-facing shipment tracking page	Closest to generic SaaS, a control case
5	Vendor rate-sheet ingestion	Links to your Silq AI project
6	ISF filing reminders for US imports	Compliance, high cost of error
7	Consolidation planning for LCL	Hard domain logic
8	Invoice dispute workflow	Finance ops
9	Sales rep workload dashboard	Internal tool
10	Carrier performance scorecard	Data product

Step 2: define what "good" means before you look at outputs

Use your five rubric dimensions, but write a concrete anchor for scores 1, 3 and 5 on each. For domain accuracy, for example: 1 = contains a factual error that would mislead engineers; 3 = correct but misses a key cost or compliance consideration; 5 = correct and names the second-order economics (e.g. who pays demurrage and when).

Step 3: run three conditions

- **A. Generic:** Claude with no RAG and no domain skill.
- **B. RAG only:** your co-pilot with style references.
- **C. Full plugin:** domain knowledge plus style matching plus template.

That's 30 outputs.

Step 4: score them two ways

- **You score all 30 blind.** Shuffle the outputs so you don't know which condition you're reading.
- **The LLM judge scores all 30 using the same rubric.**
- Then compare. Where do you and the judge agree? Where does the judge get fooled? You'll probably find the judge rewards length and confident tone, and under-penalises domain errors. That finding is gold for interviews.

Step 5: write it up as a one-page result

What to report	Example of how it should read
Headline result	"Full plugin scored 21.3/25 on average vs 14.1 for generic Claude. The biggest gap was domain accuracy (4.4 vs 2.2)."
Judge vs human agreement	"The LLM judge agreed with my scores within 1 point on 72% of items, but over-scored 4 of 10 generic outputs that had domain errors."
What you changed because of it	"Added explicit domain-error checks to the rubric and made the judge cite the line it penalised."
Cost and latency	"Full run costs ~X cents and ~Y seconds per PRD. Eval adds Z%. That's why eval is opt-in."
What you'd do next	"Expand the golden set to 30, add a second human rater, track drift when the model version changes."

The numbers above are illustrative. Use yours, whatever they are. **A modest honest result beats an impressive vague one.** If the full plugin only wins by 2 points, that's still a great story: "here's where vertical context helped and here's where it didn't."

> **Why this is the most valuable 10 hours in this whole document:** almost every AI PM interview now includes some form of "how would you evaluate this?" Most candidates answer in theory. You'll answer with "here's what I did, here's what surprised me, here's how I changed the system." That single story covers AI evaluation, LLM-as-judge limits, cost trade-offs, and domain expertise.

How to talk about the two repos in one breath

Practise this until it takes under 45 seconds:

> "I kept seeing AI tools write PRDs that sounded generic and missed the things that actually matter in freight, like surcharge stacking or who pays demurrage. So I built a RAG-based co-pilot that learns a PM's style from their past PRDs and tickets. I shipped it as a CLI first, to prove the pipeline before building any interface. Then I repackaged it as a Claude plugin with freight domain knowledge and an eval rubric weighted on domain accuracy. When I ran a blind eval across 10 features, the plugin beat generic Claude by X points, mostly on domain accuracy. The interesting finding was that the LLM judge kept over-scoring confident but wrong outputs, so I changed the rubric to force it to cite errors."

Part 4. Positioning

Who you are in the market, in one line and in 30 seconds

The positioning problem

Right now, if someone reads your CV and LinkedIn, they could file you under at least four labels: finance person, freight ops PM, internal tools PM, or AI hobbyist. When a hiring manager can't file you quickly, they don't file you at all. You need one headline that holds everything together.

Here's the thread that runs through every job you've had: **you build the systems that turn messy operational and financial data into decisions.** At Deloitte, calculation engines that replaced Excel for valuations. At Zetwerk, the Item Master and LC module that turned scattered procurement and finance data into one flow. At Silq, a pricing engine that turned rate sheets and lanes into quotes in minutes, and a credit system that turned QuickBooks and shipment data into risk visibility. And your AI work is the same idea one step further: turning messy inputs into structured outputs you can trust, with evals.

That's not a stretch. That's what you've actually done for eight years.

Your headline

> **Primary (use for Senior PM roles):** "Senior PM who builds the pricing, credit and ops systems that run B2B logistics businesses."
>
> **AI PM variant:** "Senior PM building AI for messy operational data in logistics and B2B finance."

Both are true today. The AI variant becomes much stronger once the rate-ingestion pilot is live (Part 6).

Three proof points behind the headline

Proof point	The one-line version	Where it lives
I move revenue with systems	"Quote TAT from 24 hours to under 4.5, conversion 65% to 78%, about USD 325K a month more revenue"	CV, summary, TMAY, LinkedIn About
I understand money, not just software	"Took client credit exposure from USD 1.8M to 1.2M in four months, with LCs worth INR 240 Cr a month running through a module I built at Zetwerk"	CV, fintech and platform applications
I build and evaluate AI myself	"Built and evaluated a RAG PM co-pilot and a freight-domain Claude plugin; now shipping LLM rate-sheet ingestion at work"	AI PM version, LinkedIn Featured

Your 30-second pitch (learn this by heart by end of Week 2)

> "I'm a Senior PM at Silq, a US freight forwarder, where I own the operating system the business runs on, from RFQ and quoting to rates, credit and invoicing, as the only SPM, working directly with our CTO. The work I'm proudest of is our quotation engine: we cut quote turnaround from a day to under four and a half hours, and the data showed that speed, not discounting, was what won deals, which changed how we prioritised the whole quoting roadmap. Before that I was at Zetwerk on supply chain and trade finance products, and before that three years at Deloitte building financial models. Lately I've been building AI tooling for PMs and now bringing LLM extraction into our rate ingestion. I'm looking for a role where I can do this at a company where the product is the business."

Notice what that last line does. It answers "why are you leaving?" before they ask, and it does it without complaining about Silq.

Handling "why are you leaving so soon after a promotion?"

You will get this question. Don't dodge it and don't badmouth Silq. Here's a version that is honest and lands well:

> "I'm grateful for the promotion, and I've had real autonomy at Silq. But Silq is a services business: clients pay for freight, not software. That means the product roadmap is mostly internal efficiency, which I've learned a lot from. What I want next is to own a product that customers choose and pay for, where adoption, retention and go-to-market are part of my job, not someone else's. I'd rather make that move now, with a strong track record, than in three years."

Handling "you don't have AI experience at work"

Before the pilot ships (Weeks 1 to 9):

> "Not in production yet. My day job hasn't needed it. So I built my own: a RAG co-pilot and a domain plugin, and I evaluated them properly, including where the LLM judge got fooled. I'm now scoping LLM extraction for vendor rate sheets at Silq, which is a real production problem with messy PDFs and Excel files. I can walk you through how I'm designing the evals."

After the pilot ships (Week 10 onwards):

> "Yes. I shipped an LLM extraction pipeline for vendor rate sheets at Silq. It handles X sheets a week at Y% field accuracy, with low-confidence rows going to human review. The hardest part wasn't the model, it was defining what 'correct' meant for a rate with ten surcharges and three validity windows."

That second answer is why Part 6 exists.

How to use the positioning everywhere

Surface	What to write
LinkedIn headline	Senior PM, freight and B2B platforms, building AI for logistics ops, ex-Zetwerk, ex-Deloitte

Surface	What to write
CV summary line one	Senior Product Manager with 8 years across B2B platforms, logistics, and trade finance, 5 of them in product
Cover note first line	"I build the pricing, credit and ops systems B2B logistics businesses run on, and I've started bringing LLMs into them."
Cold outreach opener	Reference their product first, then one line of your proof (templates in Part 12)
Interview "Tell me about yourself"	The 30-second pitch, extended to 90 seconds with one story

Part 5. Target role map

Which roles, which companies, and the levelling trap

You told me you want to move towards "matured organizations within this similar domain... anything like MS Dynamics, or like Flexport." That's a good instinct. Let's make it concrete and honest.

Five role archetypes, scored against your profile

Archetype	Example companies (check current openings)	Fit today	Fit after Week 10	Category
A. Senior PM, logistics and supply chain tech (India)	Shiprocket, Delhivery, Locus, FarEye, Porter, BlackBuck, Freightify, Zetwerk-type B2B marketplaces	75%	85%	Strong fit
B. Senior PM, B2B fintech in credit, invoicing, AP/AR, trade finance	Razorpay (B2B), Zoho Books and Zoho Finance, Chargebee, Cashfree B2B, HighRadius, Drip Capital	65%	75%	Strong fit
C. PM / PM II at mature global supply-chain platforms with India teams	Microsoft Dynamics 365 SCM, Blue Yonder, o9 Solutions, project44, Flexport, SAP, Oracle SCM	50%	65%	Stretch
D. AI PM, vertical AI for ops, document processing or supply chain	AI-first startups in logistics docs, procurement, AP automation, trade compliance	45%	70%	Stretch now, strong fit after pilot
E. AI PM at horizontal AI or dev tools	LLM platforms, agent frameworks, AI dev tooling	25%	40%	Aspirational

How I scored it: domain match, level match, AI evidence, and what the JD usually asks for that you can prove. The jump in D after Week 10 is entirely because of the production rate-ingestion story. That one project is worth 25 points of fit.

What each archetype will probe you on

A. Logistics tech Senior PM

- **What they want:** domain credibility, systems thinking across shipper, carrier and ops, ability to own a product area with metrics.
- **Your edge:** you've lived freight economics and Indian B2B supply chain (Zetwerk). You speak the language.
- **Your gap:** customer-facing product. Most of these companies sell software or services to shippers, and they'll ask about acquisition, onboarding, activation and retention. Close this with Part 7 (treating clients' tracking usage as a funnel) and with product sense prep on shipper-facing products.

B. B2B fintech Senior PM

- **What they want:** payments and credit understanding, integration depth (ERP, accounting), risk thinking.
- **Your edge:** the credit exposure story is exactly their world. Deloitte adds credibility. The QuickBooks sync and CDC design shows you understand data integrity, which fintech cares about deeply.
- **Your gap:** regulatory and compliance context (RBI, GST e-invoicing, TReDS for Indian players). One week of focused reading closes enough of it for interviews.

C. Mature global platform PM

- **What they want:** structured thinking, written communication, experience with enterprise customers and integrations, comfort with process.
- **Your edge:** MS Dynamics ERP integration at Zetwerk, Item Master, and an ERP-grade understanding of data layers.
- **Your gap:** enterprise customer exposure and big-company operating rhythm. Also **levelling**: expect PM or PM II, not Senior.
- **Honest note:** these processes are long (6 to 10 weeks) and often go through referrals. Start networking here in Week 5, even if you apply later.

D. Vertical AI PM

- **What they want:** someone who has shipped AI features, knows how to evaluate them, and understands the workflow deeply enough to know where AI helps and where it doesn't.
- **Your edge:** after the pilot, you'll have a production extraction story plus two evaluated side projects plus domain depth. That combination is rare.
- **Your gap:** today, no production AI. That's why you don't apply here seriously until Week 9 or 10.

E. Horizontal AI PM

Park this. You'd be competing with people who have shipped AI platforms or developer tools. Revisit in a year if you want to. It's not where your advantage is.

The levelling trap (read this twice)

Scenario	Title	What it really means	My view
SPM at a logistics or fintech SaaS company where the product is the business	Senior PM	Same title, much better product muscle	**Best outcome.** Prioritise these
PM II at Microsoft, Blue Yonder, o9 or similar	One step down	Better craft, bigger scope, structured growth, likely higher pay	**Good outcome.** Take it if the team and scope are real
SPM at another services business (forwarder, 3PL, logistics services)	Senior PM	Same problem as Silq, just bigger	**Avoid**, unless the software is being spun out as its own product
Lead or Group PM at a very early startup	Title jump	Real ownership, high risk, often little product process	Only if the founders are product-led and funded well

Decide your filter now. When an offer arrives, excitement makes this hard to think about clearly.

Tiered target list

Build your actual list in a tracker (Notion or a sheet) in Week 2. Use this structure:

Tier	Count	Who	When to start
Tier 1 (dream)	6 to 8	Archetype C mature platforms, and the two or three best-run logistics tech companies in A	Networking from Week 5, applications from Week 8
Tier 2 (strong fit)	12 to 15	Archetype A and B companies at Series B to D or later	Applications from Week 5
Tier 3 (calibration and safety)	10	Smaller logistics and fintech startups, Archetype D early stage	Applications from Week 5, to learn from real loops

> **For each company, before you apply:** open their product, read their last three launch posts or press mentions, find the PM or product leader on LinkedIn, and write one sentence on how your experience maps to their biggest product problem. If you can't write that sentence, you're not ready to apply there yet, and that's useful to know.

Geography and remote

You work for a US company from India today. Keep two doors open:

- **India-based roles** at Indian companies and at global companies with Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Gurugram or Pune product teams. This is where most of your volume should go.
- **Remote roles with US or EU logistics tech.** Your Silq experience (US freight, US clients, QuickBooks, ISF) is directly relevant. Fewer openings, more competition, but your domain is an unfair advantage. Keep this to about 20% of applications.

Part 6. Getting AI into your day job

The rate-sheet ingestion play, with a pitch, PRD outline and eval plan

This is the most important part of the document. If you do only one thing from this whole plan, do this.

Why AI at work beats another side project

You said your AI exposure at work is "almost close to none, apart from some very small tidbits." In interviews for AI PM and increasingly for any Senior PM role, the question is not "do you know what RAG is?" It's "tell me about an AI feature you shipped, what went wrong, and how you knew it was good enough." A side project can't answer the second half, because nobody depended on it.

You don't need your CTO to launch an "AI strategy". You need one scoped, boring, valuable use case that you already own. You have three candidates.

Three candidates, ranked

Option	What it is	Business value	AI learning value	Risk	My rank
1. LLM rate-sheet ingestion	Parse vendor rate sheets (Excel, PDF, email bodies) into structured rate master entries, with confidence scores and human review	High: rates are the input to your whole quoting engine. Faster, fresher, cleaner rates mean better quotes	Very high: extraction, schema design, evals, human-in-the-loop, cost	Medium: errors hit pricing, so review is mandatory	**1st**
2. RFQ email to structured RFQ	Read inbound RFQ emails and attachments, extract origin, destination, mode, commodity, weight, dates, Incoterms into a draft RFQ	High: shaves time off the start of the quote TAT you already improved	High: extraction plus classification, messier inputs	Low to medium: a human confirms every RFQ anyway	2nd
3. LLM-guided sales workload prioritisation	Suggest which RFQs each pod should work first based on win likelihood, value and urgency	Medium: depends on rep behaviour	Medium: harder to evaluate, needs outcome data	High: reps may ignore it; hard to prove impact	3rd

Go with Option 1. You already listed "complete overhaul and automation of rate ingestion from vendor rate sheets" as a current project, so this isn't a new ask. It's a decision about how to build something you're already building. If your CTO prefers Option 2, take it. It's nearly as good for your story.

> **The framing that gets a yes:** don't pitch "let's use AI." Pitch "rate ingestion takes X hours a week and our rates go stale; here are two ways to automate it, and the LLM route handles the long tail of formats that rule-based parsing can't." Sales-driven organisations fund time saved and revenue protected, not technology.

Step 1: measure the problem before you pitch (Week 1 to 2)

Spend two or three hours getting the baseline. Without it you have no story and no business case.

What to measure	How to get it	Why
Number of rate sheets received per week, by vendor	Ask procurement, or count from the shared inbox or folder for four weeks	Volume sets the business case
Number of distinct formats	Group sheets by layout. Expect a long tail	Shows why rule-based parsing breaks
Time per sheet to enter into rate master	Sit with the procurement person for one morning and time five sheets	Your main before metric
Error rate in manual entry	Sample 50 recent entries and check against source	Often higher than people think, and a strong argument
Rate staleness	How many days between a vendor sending a rate and it being live in the system	Links to quote quality and win rate
Quotes affected	How often sales quotes on an expired or missing rate and falls back to the benchmarking API or manual chase	Connects to your quotation engine story

Step 2: the pitch to your CTO (Week 2)

Send this as a short doc, then discuss in your next 1:1. Keep it to one page.

> **Subject: Rate ingestion overhaul, proposed approach**
>
> **Problem.** Procurement receives about [N] rate sheets a week from [M] vendors in [K] formats. Manual entry takes about [T] minutes per sheet, roughly [H] hours a week. We found [E]% of sampled entries had at least one error, and rates take [D] days on average to go live. When rates are missing or stale, quotes fall back to benchmarking or manual chase, which is part of our remaining quote TAT.
>
> **Options.** (a) Rule-based parsers per vendor template: fast for the top 5 vendors, breaks on every format change and never covers the long tail. (b) LLM extraction into our rate schema, with confidence scores, validation rules, and human review for anything uncertain. (c) Hybrid: rules for the top 3 stable templates, LLM for the rest.
>
> **Recommendation.** Option (c). Pilot on [5] vendors for 4 weeks in shadow mode: the system extracts, a human still enters as today, and we compare. Go live only when field-level accuracy on the eval set is above [95]% and review time is under [X] minutes per sheet.
>
> **Cost.** About [N] engineering days for the pilot. Model cost estimated under USD [Y] a month at current volume.
>
> **What we get.** [H] hours a week back for procurement, fresher rates, fewer quote fallbacks. And a pattern we can reuse for RFQ emails next.

Fill in the brackets from your Step 1 data. The shadow-mode pilot is the part that gets a sceptical CTO to yes, because it has zero risk to live pricing.

Step 3: the PRD outline (Week 3)

Write this in your normal format. Here's what it must contain, beyond your usual template, because these are the sections AI PM interviewers will ask about:

Section	What goes in it	The question it answers in interviews
Output schema	Every field: origin, destination, mode, container type, base rate, each surcharge (BAF, CAF, THC and so on), currency, validity from/to, transit time, free days, remarks. Which are required, which are optional	"How did you define the task for the model?"
Ground truth definition	What counts as correct for each field. Is USD 1,200 vs 1200.00 a match? Is a surcharge listed "as per tariff" a value or a flag?	"How did you know it was right?"
Eval set	50 to 100 real sheets across vendors and formats, hand-labelled by you and procurement. Split into easy, medium, hard	"How did you build your evals?"
Metrics	Field-level precision and recall, sheet-level fully-correct rate, confidence calibration, review time per sheet, cost per sheet, latency	"What did you measure?"
Human in the loop	Rows below a confidence threshold, or failing validation rules, go to a review queue. Reviewer edits are logged	"How did you handle errors?"
Validation rules	Deterministic checks after extraction: validity dates in the future, rates within X% of the lane's last rate, currency present, known ports	"Where did you not trust the model?"
Failure modes	Merged cells, multi-tab sheets, rates in images, notes that override the table, wrong currency, surcharges that apply only to some lanes	"What broke?"
Rollout	Shadow mode, then assisted mode (pre-filled, human confirms), then auto for high-confidence sheets from stable vendors	"How did you de-risk launch?"
Monitoring	Weekly accuracy on a sampled set, drift when vendors change templates, reviewer override rate	"How do you know it stays good?"
Cost model	Tokens per sheet, model choice, when to use a cheaper model	"How did you think about cost?"

Step 4: the eval workflow (Weeks 4 to 7)

1. **Collect 80 sheets** from the last three months across your top 15 vendors. Include at least 15 "ugly" ones.
2. **Label them.** You and one procurement person label 20 together first, to agree on rules. Then split the rest. Log every disagreement: those become your ground-truth rules.
3. **Run the baseline.** One prompt, one model, structured output against your schema. Record field-level accuracy. It'll be lower than you expect on the ugly ones. That's fine.
4. **Iterate with a log.** Change one thing at a time (schema descriptions, few-shot examples, splitting surcharges into a second pass, pre-processing Excel into clean tables). Record the accuracy after each change. This log becomes your best interview material.

5. **Set thresholds.** Pick the confidence threshold where precision on auto-accepted rows is above your target. Everything below goes to review.
6. **Measure review time.** Time procurement reviewing pre-filled sheets vs entering from scratch.

Keep a simple iteration table like this. Interviewers love seeing it:

Version	Change	Field accuracy (all)	Field accuracy (hard)	Cost per sheet	Note
v0	Single prompt, raw Excel text	e.g. 78%	e.g. 51%	USD 0.04	Surcharges missed when in notes
v1	Excel pre-processed into clean tables	85%	63%	0.03	Merged cells fixed
v2	Two-pass: base rates, then surcharges	90%	74%	0.06	Cost up, accuracy up
v3	Validation rules plus review queue	97% on auto-accepted	n/a	0.06	30% of rows go to review

Numbers above are illustrative. Your real ones will differ, and that's the point.

Step 5: shadow pilot and launch (Weeks 7 to 10)

- **Weeks 7 to 8:** shadow mode on 5 vendors. Compare system output with manual entry every day. Track disagreements.
- **Week 9:** assisted mode for those 5. Procurement reviews pre-filled entries instead of typing. Measure time per sheet.
- **Week 10:** decide: expand, iterate, or stop. Write a one-page result note to your CTO, whatever the outcome.

What you'll be able to say at the end

- **CV bullet (example shape):** "Shipped LLM rate-sheet extraction across [N] vendors, cutting entry time per sheet from [X] to [Y] minutes at [Z]% field accuracy, with low-confidence rows routed to human review."
- **Interview story:** covered in full STAR form in Part 11.
- **LinkedIn post:** "What I learned putting an LLM in front of freight rate sheets" (anonymised, no vendor names, no Silq numbers without approval).

What if the CTO says no?

It happens, especially in sales-driven companies. Three fallbacks, in order:

1. **Ask for the shadow pilot only.** "Let me run it on the side for four weeks. No live changes. If the numbers aren't there, we drop it." Very hard to refuse.
2. **Switch to Option 2 (RFQ email parsing)**, which is lower risk because a human already confirms every RFQ.

3. **Build it outside work on synthetic data.** Create 50 fictional but realistic rate sheets (vary layouts, add ugly ones) and build the pipeline as your capstone (Part 9). You lose the "in production" claim, but you keep the eval depth and the domain credibility.

> **One boundary:** don't take real Silq rate sheets, client data or vendor contracts out of the company to build anything personal. Check your employment agreement on IP for work-related side projects. If in doubt, ask your CTO. Your integrity is worth more to your next employer than any demo.

Part 7. Building product muscle at Silq

Turning "business asked, I delivered" into product decisions you can talk about

You said you're "working and focusing on problems that are P0 for the business, not necessarily for the product." That won't change while you're at Silq, and you shouldn't try to fight it head on. What you can change is how you work on those P0s. Five habits, each one small, each one producing a story.

Habit 1: instrument the quoting funnel and review it every week

Right now you measured quote TAT and conversion at launch. Turn that into a living funnel you look at every Monday.

The metric tree

Level	Metric	Cut by
North star	Won shipments per week from quotes (or gross profit from quoted shipments)	Month, mode
Input 1	RFQs received	Client, lane, mode, source (email, portal, rep)
Input 2	Quote coverage: % of RFQs quoted	Lane, mode, rate availability
Input 3	Speed: median and p90 time from RFQ to quote	Rep, pod, lane, rate source (internal vs API vs manual chase)
Input 4	Win rate on quoted RFQs	Speed bucket, price position vs benchmark, client tier
Guardrail	Gross margin per won shipment	Lane, rep

What to do with it

1. **Week 2:** build the dashboard in Metabase (you already have MCP access from Cursor, so you can draft the SQL fast).
2. **Weeks 3 to 12:** every Monday, write three lines in a running doc: what moved, why you think it moved, what you'll check. This takes 20 minutes.
3. **Look for one surprise.** There's almost always one. Maybe p90 TAT is still 20 hours for a specific mode. Maybe win rate falls off a cliff after a certain number of hours. Maybe manual-chase lanes win less even when fast. That surprise is your next product decision.

> **Why this matters for interviews:** "How did you measure success after launch?" and "Tell me about a metric that surprised you" are standard Senior PM questions. Right now your answer ends at launch. In ten weeks it won't.

Habit 2: run discovery with your internal users, properly

Your users are sales reps, procurement, ops and finance. Most internal tool PMs never interview them properly. They take requests. Do eight interviews over four weeks.

Who	How many	What to learn
Sales reps (mix of top and average performers)	3	Where they still leave the app to finish a quote. What they do when a rate is missing. What they tell clients when quotes are slow
Procurement	2	How rate sheets arrive, where time goes, what errors cost them (feeds Part 6)
Ops	2	Where shipment status updates break, and what clients ask them most
Finance	1	How they use the credit views, what still happens in Excel

Five questions that work well with internal users:

1. "Walk me through the last quote or task you did, step by step. Can you share your screen?"
2. "Where did you leave the app to do something somewhere else? Why?"
3. "What's the most annoying thing you did this week that the app should have done?"
4. "When the app gave you a wrong or missing answer, what did you do?"
5. "If you could get one hour a week back, where would it come from?"

Write up each interview in five bullets. After eight, cluster the findings into three or four themes. That synthesis is a portfolio piece and a Senior PM story ("I found that 40% of rep time on complex quotes was spent outside the app, which reshaped our roadmap").

Habit 3: write a one-page decision memo for every big business ask

This is the habit that fixes "shifting with the tide." You don't refuse business asks. You write them down as decisions.

Section	One or two lines
The ask	What was requested, by whom, and why they want it
The problem underneath	What's actually going wrong, with a number if you have one
Options	At least two, including "do nothing" and a smaller version
Recommendation	What you'll do, and what you won't do as a result
How we'll know	The metric and the date you'll check it

Two things happen when you do this consistently. First, leadership starts to see you as someone who shapes priorities, not just executes them. Second, within a quarter you'll have at least one memo where you recommended a different or smaller solution than what was asked, and it worked. That's your "pushed back on a stakeholder" story, and it's the question you'd struggle with most in a Senior PM loop today.

> **The language that works in sales-driven orgs:** never say "no". Say "yes, and here's what it costs": "We can build X by the 15th. That pushes Y, which is saving procurement 10 hours a week, by three weeks. Alternatively, a smaller version gets you 80% of X in one week. Which do you prefer?" You've made the trade-off visible and let the business choose. That's product management.

Habit 4: treat the client tracking experience as a real product

You mentioned clients "are using it, but they're not paying us for it, but they're using it to track their cargo." That's your one customer-facing surface, and it's your closest thing to a funnel and retention problem. Use it.

- **Measure it:** weekly active client users, logins per active shipment, % of clients who log in at all, and most importantly, the volume of "where is my shipment" emails and calls to ops.
- **Find the job:** interview three client users. What do they check? What do they forward to their own team? What do they still ask ops by email?
- **Ship one improvement** aimed at deflecting status queries (for example proactive milestone emails, a shareable tracking link, or an exception alert when an ETA slips).
- **Measure the result:** did "where is my shipment" emails drop? Did client logins go up or down (both can be good, depending on the design)?

That gives you a customer-facing story with adoption, engagement and support deflection metrics. It directly answers the "you've only built internal tools" objection.

Habit 5: measure your own delivery, and your APM's growth

- **Delivery speed.** Your CV claims an AI-accelerated workflow. Back it with a number. For the next six features, log three dates: problem agreed, PRD ready for engineering, first ticket in progress. Compare with your last six features before the co-pilot. Even a rough comparison gives you an honest number.
- **Your APM's promotion.** Write down what you did: how you delegated, what you let them own, how you gave feedback, what went wrong. "Tell me about someone you developed" is a standard Senior PM behavioural question, and you have a real promotion to point to.

The 12-week Silq product calendar

Weeks	Silq product actions	Story it produces
1 to 2	Baseline rate-ingestion data. Build quote funnel dashboard. Pitch the rate-ingestion approach	"Measured before building"
3 to 4	4 internal user interviews. First decision memo. PRD for rate ingestion	Discovery, trade-offs
5 to 6	4 more interviews plus synthesis. Label eval set. Client tracking metrics baseline	Discovery synthesis, eval design
7 to 8	Shadow pilot. One client tracking improvement scoped. Second decision memo	AI in production, customer-facing
9 to 10	Assisted mode. Pilot result note. Client tracking improvement shipped	AI outcome, deflection metric

Weeks	Silq product actions	Story it produces
11 to 12	Quarterly product review doc to CTO: what we learned, what we'll stop, what's next	Strategy, influence

The quarterly review doc (Week 11 to 12)

End the quarter by writing a four-page product review for your CTO and co-founder. Structure: what we shipped and what it moved; what the funnel told us; what users told us; the AI pilot result; three things we should stop or not build; the next quarter's bets with expected impact. This one document does three things: it raises your standing at Silq, it's the best practice you'll get for strategy interview questions, and a sanitised version is a portfolio piece.

Part 8. AI upskilling curriculum

What to learn, in what order, and the exercise that proves you learned it

You've already been through the Ayuda modules and some courses online, and you told me you have "some grip knowledge-wise on what RAG is, how to evaluate... when to and when not to use AI." So I'm not going to send you back to basics. This curriculum is about depth in the six areas AI PM interviewers actually probe, and every block ends in an exercise tied to your real work.

Attend the Ayuda weekend AI sessions during this period, especially the ones on evaluation, RAG and building LLM apps. Treat them as the place to bring questions from the exercises below, not as the place you first hear a concept.

The six blocks at a glance

Block	Weeks	Theme	Exercise output
1	1 to 2	LLM mechanics a PM must own: cost, latency, context, structured output	Cost and latency model for rate ingestion
2	2 to 4	Structured extraction and prompt design	v0 to v2 extraction on 10 sample sheets
3	3 to 6	Evaluation: golden sets, metrics, LLM-as-judge, human agreement	Co-pilot eval write-up (Part 3)
4	6 to 8	RAG done properly: retrieval quality, not just generation	Retrieval metrics added to the co-pilot
5	8 to 10	Agents, tool use and MCP: when to use them and when not to	Design doc: agentic RFQ triage, with a "why not" section
6	10 to 12	AI product management: UX for uncertainty, rollout, monitoring, strategy	"Where AI changes freight forwarding" memo

Block 1: LLM mechanics a PM must own (Weeks 1 to 2)

What to learn. Tokens and how pricing works per input and output token. Context windows and what happens to quality when you stuff them. Temperature and why extraction wants it low. Structured outputs (JSON schema, tool calling) vs free text. Model tiers: when a smaller, cheaper model is good enough. Latency drivers. Batch vs real-time.

Why for you. In your rate-ingestion pitch, your CTO will ask "how much will this cost and how long will it take per sheet?" If you can't answer in numbers, the pitch loses credibility. In interviews, "how did you think about cost?" separates PMs who shipped AI from PMs who demoed it.

Exercise. Take five sample rate sheets (anonymised or synthetic). Estimate tokens per sheet (Excel converted to text or markdown). Calculate monthly cost at your weekly volume for two model tiers. Estimate latency. Put it in a one-page table and use it in the Week 2 CTO pitch.

Done when. You can say, without notes: "Each sheet is about X tokens in and Y out. On the mid-tier model that's about Z cents a sheet, under USD N a month at our volume. We'd use the smaller model for the first pass and the larger one only for low-confidence rows."

Block 2: structured extraction and prompt design (Weeks 2 to 4)

What to learn. Schema design as the real prompt (field descriptions matter more than clever instructions). Few-shot examples, and choosing them from your hardest cases. Pre-processing: cleaning Excel into tables before the model sees it. Multi-pass designs (extract base rates first, surcharges second). Asking the model for confidence or evidence (which cell it read the value from). Deterministic validation after the model.

Why for you. This is the core of the Silq AI project, and extraction is the most common production LLM use case in B2B. Once you understand it deeply, you can talk credibly about invoices, bills of lading, customs documents, and purchase orders too. Every one of those is a vertical AI company.

Exercise. Run v0, v1 and v2 of the extraction on 10 sheets, and fill in the iteration table from Part 6. Write two paragraphs on what changed accuracy most. (My guess: pre-processing and schema descriptions will beat prompt wording. See if you're right.)

Done when. You can explain why your v2 is better than v0 with numbers, and name the two failure modes you haven't fixed yet.

Block 3: evaluation (Weeks 3 to 6)

This is the block that matters most. Evaluation is where AI PMs earn their seniority.

What to learn.

- Golden sets: how big, how to pick hard cases, how to avoid leaking them into your prompts.
- Metrics for extraction (field-level precision and recall, exact vs normalised match) vs metrics for generation (rubric scores, pairwise preference).
- LLM-as-judge: when it works, and its known biases (preferring longer answers, preferring its own style, missing domain errors).
- Human agreement: why you check the judge against human labels, and what agreement rate is acceptable.
- Regression testing: re-running evals whenever you change a prompt or a model version.
- Offline evals vs online signals (reviewer override rate, user edits, complaints).

Why for you. You built an eval rubric but haven't published a single result. And on the call you flagged "how to try to measure non-deterministic outputs" as something you have "an okay grip on." This block turns okay into strong.

Reading. Anthropic's documentation on creating strong empirical evaluations (you already referenced their eval material in your README). Hamel Husain's writing on evals for LLM products. Eugene Yan's "Patterns for building LLM-based systems and products". Chip Huyen's book *AI Engineering*, the chapters on evaluation.

Exercise. Run the full co-pilot eval from Part 3 (10 prompts, 3 conditions, blind human scoring plus judge scoring). Publish the one-page result in the repo.

Done when. You can answer this in under two minutes, with your own numbers: "How would you evaluate an LLM feature before and after launch?"

Block 4: RAG done properly (Weeks 6 to 8)

What to learn. Chunking strategies and why they matter for PRDs (sections vs fixed size). Retrieval metrics (recall at k: did the right reference chunk come back?). Hybrid search (keyword plus embeddings). Metadata filtering, which you already use with doc_type. When RAG fails: the answer isn't in the corpus, or retrieval returns plausible but wrong context. When long context beats RAG.

Why for you. Your co-pilot uses RAG, but you only evaluate the final output. A senior interviewer will ask "was the problem retrieval or generation?" You need to be able to tell them apart.

Exercise. For 10 co-pilot runs, log which chunks were retrieved and whether they were the right style references. Calculate a simple recall at k. Try one change (chunk by section instead of fixed size, or add keyword search). Report the difference.

Done when. You can draw the RAG pipeline on a whiteboard and point to where each of three failure types happens.

Block 5: agents, tool use and MCP (Weeks 8 to 10)

What to learn. The difference between workflows (fixed steps with LLM calls) and agents (the model decides the next step). Anthropic's "Building effective agents" post is the clearest read on this. Tool design. Failure modes: loops, wrong tool, compounding errors. Guardrails and human checkpoints. MCP as a way to connect tools, which you already use daily in Cursor with Metabase and Linear.

Why for you. Every AI PM loop now has an "agent" question. The strongest answer is usually "here's why I would not use an agent for this, and where I would." Your freight domain is full of multi-step workflows (RFQ to quote to booking) where you can show that judgment.

Exercise. Write a three-page design doc: "Agentic RFQ triage for a freight forwarder." Include the workflow, what the agent could do, which steps should be deterministic, where a human must confirm, how you'd evaluate it, and a section titled "Why I'd ship a workflow first." Don't build it. The thinking is the proof.

Done when. You can explain when you'd choose a workflow over an agent in one sentence, with a freight example.

Block 6: AI product management and strategy (Weeks 10 to 12)

What to learn.

- **UX for uncertainty:** showing confidence, review queues, "why" explanations, easy correction, and learning from corrections.
- **Rollout:** shadow mode, assisted mode, autonomous mode. Kill criteria.
- **Monitoring and drift:** vendor template changes, model version changes, seasonal patterns.
- **Trust and adoption:** why ops users stop trusting AI after one bad error, and how to design for that.
- **Data and privacy:** what can and can't go to a third-party model, retention, customer contracts.
- **Strategy:** where AI creates advantage in a vertical (proprietary workflow data, labelled corrections, integration depth) vs where it's a commodity feature.

Why for you. This is the layer that makes you an AI PM rather than an AI builder. It's also where your domain depth pays off most.

Exercise. Write the "Where AI changes freight forwarding in the next three years" memo (Project 4 in Part 9). Map 10 forwarding workflows by AI readiness and value. Take a position.

Done when. You can hold a 20-minute conversation with a vertical AI founder about their product and add something they hadn't considered.

> **A trap to avoid:** don't collect certificates. Nobody hiring an AI PM asks for them. Every hour in this curriculum should end in something you can show: a table, a result, a design doc, a post.

Part 9. Proof of work plan

Four projects, each with a claim story, CV bullet and LinkedIn angle

Three deep projects beat eight shallow ones. You already have two builds. The plan below upgrades them, adds one production AI capstone, and adds two thinking pieces that show the product and strategy depth your day job doesn't let you show.

Overview

#	Project	Format	Weeks	Closes which gap
1	PM co-pilot and logistics-pm: evaluated and written up	Repo fixes, eval result, write-up	1 to 5	AI evidence, eval depth
2	AI capstone: LLM rate-sheet extraction	Production pilot at Silq (or synthetic fallback), 1-page write-up	3 to 10	AI in production (the big one)
3	Shipper-side product teardown: quoting and booking in Indian logistics tech	Teardown plus redesign in Figma	6 to 8	Customer-facing product sense
4	"Where AI changes freight forwarding" memo	Strategy doc plus long LinkedIn post	11 to 13	Strategy, point of view

Project 1: PM co-pilot and logistics-pm, evaluated and written up

What you're doing. Fixing the repos (Part 3), running the blind three-condition eval, and writing it up as one page in the README plus a LinkedIn post.

Why this connects to you. It's your own problem, in your own domain, and you've already done 80% of the build. The missing 20% is the evidence.

Timing. Repo fixes in Week 1. Eval in Weeks 3 to 4. Write-up and post in Week 5.

Claim story (interview-ready).

> "I was using AI every day to draft PRDs and tickets, and the output kept sounding generic and missing the freight-specific things my engineers needed, like surcharge logic or integration failure handling. So I built a RAG co-pilot that uses a PM's own past documents as style references. I chose RAG over fine-tuning because a PM has maybe two or three good PRDs, not hundreds. I shipped it as a CLI first to prove the pipeline before building any UI. Then I packaged it as a Claude plugin with freight domain knowledge. To know if it actually helped, I ran a blind eval: 10 features, three conditions, scored by me and by an LLM judge. The plugin beat generic Claude by [X] points, mostly on domain accuracy. The surprise was that the judge over-scored confident but wrong outputs [N] times out of 10, so I changed the rubric to make the judge cite each error. If I did it again, I'd build the golden set before writing any code."

CV bullet. Built and evaluated a RAG PM co-pilot and freight-domain Claude plugin; blind eval across 10 features showed a [X]-point gain over generic Claude, driven by domain accuracy.

LinkedIn angle. "I ran a blind eval on my own AI tool. The LLM judge got fooled more than I expected. Here's what I changed."

Project 2 (AI capstone): LLM rate-sheet extraction

What you're building. The Part 6 pilot: vendor rate sheets in, structured rate master entries out, with confidence, validation rules and a human review queue. Shadow mode, then assisted mode, on five vendors.

Why this connects to you. You own rate ingestion at Silq. Rates feed the quotation engine you built. It closes the loop on your best story.

Format. Production pilot plus a one-page write-up. If the CTO says no, the synthetic-data fallback from Part 6.

Timing. Scoping Weeks 1 to 3. Eval set Weeks 4 to 6. Iteration Weeks 5 to 7. Shadow and assisted mode Weeks 7 to 10. Write-up Week 10. **I review the write-up in Week 10.**

The one-page write-up structure.

Section	Length
Problem and baseline (volume, time per sheet, error rate, staleness)	4 to 5 lines
Why LLM, and why not rules alone	3 lines
Design: schema, pre-processing, passes, validation, review queue	6 lines plus a small diagram
Evaluation: golden set, metrics, iteration table	Table
Pilot results: accuracy, review time, cost, reviewer override rate	4 lines
What broke and what I'd do next	4 lines

Claim story. Written out in full STAR form in Part 11 (Story 3). Draft it after Week 10 with your real numbers.

CV bullet (shape). Shipped LLM rate-sheet extraction across [N] vendors, cutting entry time per sheet from [X] to [Y] min at [Z]% field accuracy, with low-confidence rows routed to human review.

LinkedIn angle. "Freight rate sheets are where clean AI demos go to die. Here's what it took to get an LLM to read them reliably." (Anonymised. No vendor names, no Silq numbers unless your CTO is fine with it.)

> **Remember:** the prototype is the artifact. The write-up is the portfolio. How you identified the problem, validated it, made trade-offs and evaluated the output is what gets you hired.

Project 3: shipper-side product teardown

What you're building. A teardown of how a shipper gets a quote and books freight on two logistics platforms (for example an Indian player like Shiprocket's cargo or B2B offering, or Freightify for forwarders, and a global one like Freightos or Flexport's customer app, whatever you can access as a user). Map the journey, find the friction, then design one improvement in Figma with a metrics plan.

Why this connects to you. It directly attacks your biggest Senior PM gap: customer-facing product sense. And you know the backend of quoting better than almost any PM who'd do this teardown, so you'll spot things others miss, like where the quote hides surcharges or how transit time is presented.

Format. 6 to 8 page teardown plus 3 to 4 Figma screens.

Timing. Weeks 6 to 8.

Structure.

1. The shipper's job to be done, in their words (talk to two shippers or freight buyers you know through Silq or Zetwerk contacts).
2. Journey map across both platforms: steps, time, drop-off points, trust signals.
3. The three biggest frictions, ranked by likely impact on quote-to-book conversion.
4. One redesign, with the reasoning and what you'd cut.
5. Metrics: quote-to-book conversion, time to first quote, repeat quote rate, and a guardrail.
6. What your Silq data taught you that applies here (speed beats price).

Claim story.

> "At Silq I'd seen from our own data that speed of quote mattered more than price for win rate. I wanted to know if shipper-facing platforms were designed around that insight. I went through the quoting and booking flow on two platforms as a user and interviewed two freight buyers. The biggest finding was [X]: for example, that total landed cost only appears at the last step, so shippers compare base rates and get surprised later. I redesigned the quote screen to show all-in cost and transit certainty up front, and defined quote-to-book conversion as the metric with dispute rate as the guardrail."

CV bullet. Not a CV bullet. Use it in interviews and as a Featured item on LinkedIn.

LinkedIn angle. "I tried to book freight like a shipper on two platforms. Here's where they lose me, and what a forwarder's data says they should fix."

Project 4: "Where AI changes freight forwarding"

What you're building. A 4 to 5 page strategy memo mapping ten forwarding workflows (RFQ intake, rate ingestion, quoting, booking, documentation, customs filing, tracking and exceptions, invoicing, disputes, collections) on two axes: value of automation and AI readiness today. Take a clear position on where vertical AI wins, where it's a feature, and where it's hype.

Why this connects to you. Strategy is the other big Senior PM gap your job doesn't exercise. And a sharp, opinionated domain memo is the single best thing you can send a hiring manager at a vertical AI or logistics tech company.

Format. Memo plus a long LinkedIn post, and optionally a one-slide 2x2.

Timing. Weeks 11 to 13.

Claim story.

> "After shipping the rate-extraction pilot, I wanted to step back and ask where AI actually creates advantage in forwarding. I mapped ten workflows by value and readiness. My view is that document-heavy, high-volume steps like rate ingestion and RFQ intake are ready now and are table stakes within two years, while exception management is the high-value, hard problem where proprietary workflow data becomes a moat. I'd bet a product on exceptions, not on quoting."

LinkedIn angle. "Ten workflows in freight forwarding, ranked by how ready they are for AI. My bet is not where most people think."

Hackathons

Join the Ayuda hackathons during Weeks 3 to 12 when your schedule allows. Aim for two. Use them for speed practice on product sense and AI prototyping in unfamiliar domains, which keeps you from becoming "the freight guy" in interviews.

Part 10. The 16-week plan

Week by week, 28 September 2026 to 17 January 2027

You're working full time, so this plan assumes about 8 to 10 hours a week outside work, plus the Silq actions that happen inside your normal job. Each week has four tracks: **Silq** (inside your job), **AI learning**, **Proof of work**, and **Market** (CV, LinkedIn, applications, interview prep). Every week ends with a self-check. If you miss a self-check two weeks running, don't push harder, cut scope and message the peer group.

Phase 1: Fix and position (Weeks 1 to 3)

Week 1 (28 Sep to 4 Oct): fix the risks, start the baseline

Track	Actions
Silq	Start the rate-ingestion baseline: count sheets and vendors for the last four weeks, sit with procurement for one morning and time five sheets. Start the 6-feature delivery log (Part 7, Habit 5)
AI learning	Block 1: tokens, pricing, structured outputs, model tiers. Estimate token counts on five synthetic or anonymised sheets
Proof of work	Fix the confidentiality issue in logistics-pm (Part 3) first. Delete venv, fix .gitignore, add Mac/Linux setup, rename the co-pilot repo, add the v1 to v2 line to both READMEs, fix Shipco vs Xeneta
Market	Review both new CVs. Replace or remove every placeholder metric (Part 2 table). Message two old Zetwerk colleagues for LC and inventory numbers. Update LinkedIn headline

Self-check: Are both repos safe to show a hiring manager today? Is every number on your CV one you can defend?

Week 2 (5 to 11 Oct): pitch and position

Track	Actions
Silq	Finish the baseline (error sample of 50 entries, staleness, quote fallbacks). Send the one-page rate-ingestion pitch to your CTO and discuss it in your 1:1. Build the quote funnel dashboard in Metabase
AI learning	Finish Block 1: one-page cost and latency table for the pitch. Start Block 2: read up on schema-first extraction
Proof of work	Write the 10-prompt golden set for the co-pilot eval, and the 1-3-5 anchors for each rubric dimension
Market	Learn the 30-second pitch by heart. Record yourself saying it, watch it once, re-record. Rewrite LinkedIn About. Build your target company tracker with 30 names across three tiers (Part 5). **Send me CV v1 once placeholders are fixed**

Self-check: Can you say your pitch without notes in under 35 seconds? Has your CTO heard the rate-ingestion proposal?

Week 3 (12 to 18 Oct): PRD and first post

Track	Actions
Silq	Write the rate-ingestion PRD with the AI sections from Part 6. Do the first two internal user interviews (one sales rep, one procurement). First Monday funnel note
AI learning	Block 2: run v0 extraction on 10 sheets (synthetic or approved samples). Start Block 3 reading on evals
Proof of work	Run the co-pilot eval: generate 30 outputs across three conditions
Market	First LinkedIn post: "Why I built my own PM co-pilot" (problem, what you built, one thing you learned). Start product sense practice: 2 questions this week, using the self-evaluation rubric in Part 11

Self-check: Is the PRD good enough that an engineer could start? Did you post, even if it felt early?

Phase 2: Build the stories (Weeks 4 to 10)

Week 4 (19 to 25 Oct): eval set and scoring

Track	Actions
Silq	Start collecting the 80-sheet eval set. Label the first 20 together with procurement, and log every disagreement as a ground-truth rule. Two more user interviews (ops)
AI learning	Block 3: LLM-as-judge biases, human agreement. Block 2: v1 extraction with pre-processing
Proof of work	Blind-score all 30 co-pilot outputs yourself. Run the LLM judge. Compare
Market	2 product sense questions plus 1 metrics question. **Send me your first two mock answers** (recorded or written) for calibration

Self-check: Do you know where you and the LLM judge disagreed, and why?

Week 5 (26 Oct to 1 Nov): publish and start applying

Track	Actions
Silq	Finish labelling. First decision memo on whatever big ask arrives this week. Two final user interviews (finance, one more rep)
AI learning	Block 3: regression testing, offline vs online signals. Write the eval result one-pager
Proof of work	Publish Project 1: eval results in README, demo GIF, LinkedIn post
Market	**Applications start: 4 this week**, all Tier 3 or Tier 2, using the SPM CV. Start 3 LinkedIn connection notes to PMs at Tier 1 companies (no ask yet, just a comment on their work)

Self-check: Did you apply to 4 roles, even though you don't feel ready? Good. That's the point.

Week 6 (2 to 8 Nov): discovery synthesis

Track	Actions
Silq	Synthesise the eight interviews into 3 or 4 themes. Share a one-page summary with your CTO. Baseline the client tracking metrics (Habit 4)
AI learning	Block 4: RAG retrieval metrics. Log retrieved chunks for 10 co-pilot runs
Proof of work	Rate extraction v2 (two-pass) on the full eval set. Update the iteration table. Start Project 3: pick the two platforms, book two shipper conversations
Market	4 applications. 1 cold outreach message per day on weekdays (5 total), using templates in Part 12. 2 product sense plus 1 strategy question. LinkedIn post on something you learned from the eval

Self-check: Could you tell the "what I learned from interviewing our own sales reps" story right now?

Week 7 (9 to 15 Nov): shadow pilot starts (Diwali week, keep it lighter)

Track	Actions
Silq	Shadow mode on 5 vendors: system extracts, humans still enter manually, you compare daily
AI learning	Block 4 exercise: try section-based chunking, compare recall
Proof of work	Project 3: journey mapping on both platforms, two shipper conversations
Market	3 applications. 1 peer mock (you interview, then you get interviewed). Skip the post if needed, it's Diwali

Self-check: Is the shadow pilot running every day without you babysitting it?

Week 8 (16 to 22 Nov): scale up the market track

Track	Actions
Silq	Shadow mode week 2. Log every disagreement type. Scope one client tracking improvement. Second decision memo
AI learning	Block 5: workflows vs agents, tool design, MCP. Read Anthropic's "Building effective agents"
Proof of work	Project 3: redesign in Figma and write-up. Publish
Market	**Step up to 6 applications a week.** Tier 1 networking: ask two of the PMs you've been engaging with for a 15-minute chat. 2 peer mocks. LinkedIn: Project 3 post

Self-check: Do you have at least one active interview process? If you've had zero callbacks from 15 applications, go to "When callbacks are low" in Part 12 this week.

Week 9 (23 to 29 Nov): assisted mode

Track	Actions
Silq	Assisted mode on the 5 vendors: procurement reviews pre-filled entries. Measure review time per sheet vs manual entry. Track reviewer override rate

Track	Actions
AI learning	Block 5 exercise: agentic RFQ triage design doc
Proof of work	Start drafting the capstone write-up with numbers as they come in
Market	6 applications, now including Archetype D (vertical AI) with the AI PM CV. 5 outreach messages. Story bank practice: record Stories 1 and 2 (Part 11)

Self-check: Can you give the accuracy, review time and cost numbers from memory?

Week 10 (30 Nov to 6 Dec): pilot decision and capstone write-up

Track	Actions
Silq	Decide: expand, iterate or stop. Write the one-page result note to your CTO. Ship the client tracking improvement
AI learning	Start Block 6: UX for uncertainty, rollout, monitoring
Proof of work	Finish the capstone one-page write-up. **Send it to me for review.** Update the AI PM CV: replace the "leading" bullet with the real outcome bullet
Market	6 applications. 2 peer mocks focusing on AI PM questions. LinkedIn: anonymised post on what you learned putting an LLM in front of rate sheets (check with your CTO first)

Self-check: Is "I shipped an LLM feature into production" now a true sentence? If the pilot stopped, can you tell the story of why, well? (A well-told "we stopped it because" story is also strong.)

Phase 3: Go to market (Weeks 11 to 16)

Week 11 (7 to 13 Dec): full push

Track	Actions
Silq	Start the quarterly product review doc (Part 7). Measure the client tracking change
AI learning	Block 6: data privacy, AI strategy, where vertical AI creates advantage
Proof of work	Start Project 4: map the ten workflows
Market	8 applications across tiers. 5 outreach. Ask for referrals from anyone you've had a good conversation with. 3 mocks this week, including one full SPM loop simulation

Self-check: Do you have 3 or more active processes? If not, what's the blocker: CV, targeting, volume, or conversion?

Week 12 (14 to 20 Dec): quarterly review and interviews

Track	Actions
Silq	Deliver the quarterly product review to your CTO and co-founder
AI learning	Finish Block 6

Track	Actions
Proof of work	Project 4 first draft
Market	6 to 8 applications. Company-specific prep for every active process (use the interview prep doc format; ask me if you have a final round). Keep a mistake log after every real interview

Self-check: After each real interview, did you write down the three questions you answered worst within 24 hours?

Week 13 (21 to 27 Dec): holiday lull, build and prepare

Hiring slows in the last two weeks of December in most companies. Use it.

Track	Actions
Silq	Light. Update the funnel note
Proof of work	Finish and publish Project 4 (memo and long post). This goes out when people are reading more and posting less
Market	2 or 3 applications only. Deep prep: rewrite all six STAR stories with the new numbers. Do two full mock loops

Week 14 (28 Dec to 3 Jan): reset

Track	Actions
Market	Review the tracker. Which tier converted? Which CV version? Which outreach template got replies? Shift January effort towards what worked. Refresh the target list with 10 new names. Prepare January outreach

Self-check: Could you explain to a friend, with numbers, where your funnel is leaking?

Week 15 (4 to 10 Jan): January restart

Track	Actions
Market	8 applications (hiring budgets reopen in January). 5 outreach messages. Follow up on every open conversation from November and December. 2 mocks
Silq	Keep the weekly funnel note going. It's now a habit, and a story

Week 16 (11 to 17 Jan): close

Track	Actions
Market	8 applications. Push every active process to the next stage. If you have an offer, tell other processes (politely) and ask about timelines. Use the negotiation notes in Part 12
Review	Score yourself against the tracker in Part 13. Book a 30-minute call with me to plan the next eight weeks, whether that's closing offers or adjusting the approach

The whole plan on one page

Weeks	Silq	AI learning	Proof of work	Market
1 to 3	Baseline, pitch, PRD, funnel dashboard	Blocks 1 and 2	Repo fixes, golden set, eval run	CV v1 to me, pitch, LinkedIn, first post
4 to 6	Eval set, 8 interviews, first memo	Blocks 3 and 4	Project 1 published	Mocks to me, applications start Week 5
7 to 10	Shadow then assisted pilot, result note	Blocks 4 and 5	Capstone write-up to me, Project 3	6 a week, outreach, peer mocks
11 to 13	Quarterly review doc	Block 6	Project 4	8 a week, referrals, company prep
14 to 16	Keep funnel habit	Review	Update everything with real numbers	Restart, close, negotiate

Part 11. Interview prep

Story bank with full STAR answers, and question banks for SPM and AI PM loops

What the loops will look like

Round	Senior PM (logistics, B2B, fintech)	AI PM (vertical AI)
Recruiter or HM screen	Why you, why now, why leaving after a promotion	Same, plus "what AI have you shipped?"
Product sense	Design or improve a B2B or shipper-facing product	Design an AI feature for a workflow; handle uncertainty and errors
Metrics / analytics	Define success, diagnose a drop (RCA), SQL-light case	How would you evaluate this model or feature, before and after launch?
Strategy	Where should this product go, build vs buy, pricing, competition	Where does AI create a moat here, build vs buy models, cost
Execution / behavioural	Stakeholders, conflict, prioritisation, failure, leading a team	Same, plus "tell me about an AI launch that went wrong"
Take-home or case (often)	PRD or strategy doc	Prototype plus eval plan

Story bank: which story for which question

Question type	Your go-to story	Backup story
Biggest impact / proudest launch	Story 1: Quotation engine	Story 2: Credit exposure
Data-driven decision, insight that surprised you	Story 1: speed beats price	Funnel surprise from Part 7 (Week 6 onwards)
Technical trade-off, working with engineering	Story 2: webhooks plus CDC	Story 3: two-pass extraction
AI feature you shipped, evaluation	Story 3: Rate-sheet extraction	Project 1 eval (LLM judge got fooled)
Disagreed with a stakeholder, said no	Story 4: Decision memo pushback	Story 6: Zetwerk LC rollout
Led or developed people	Story 5: APM to PM	Leading the pod at Zetwerk
Cross-functional alignment across many teams	Story 6: LC module across 8 BUs	Story 2 (Finance, Sales, Ops)
Failure or something you'd do differently	Story 7: pick your own (guidance below)	The pilot, if it underperformed
Customer empathy	Client tracking improvement (Part 7, Habit 4)	Project 3 shipper interviews

Write all seven in your own words, then record yourself telling each in under three minutes. The drafts below are built from your CV and our call. Anything in square brackets you must fill in with real detail.

Story 1: The quotation engine (impact, insight, 0-to-1)

Situation. At Silq, a US freight forwarder, quoting was the bottleneck in the sales funnel. Reps took about 24 hours on average to turn an RFQ into a client-ready quote, because rates lived in scattered sheets, lane pricing was manual, and transit times were pieced together by hand. The business believed we were losing deals on price, and the default instinct was to discount.

Task. I owned building the quoting product 0-to-1. The real question underneath was whether we were losing on price or on speed, because that decided what we should build.

Action. I started by pulling [N months] of quote data and looking at win rate by response time and by price position. [Describe what you saw, for example: win rates dropped sharply after about 8 hours, and within the same time bucket, being slightly more expensive didn't hurt much.] That shifted the goal from "cheapest quote" to "fastest accurate quote". We built a pricing engine on rate masters and lane pricing, with dynamic transit-time construction, so a rep could generate a client-ready quote from an RFQ in minutes. I made a deliberate trade-off to launch with [the top N lanes / modes] where we had clean rates, rather than cover everything at launch, because a fast quote on 70% of RFQs was worth more than a slow launch covering 100%. For lanes without internal rates, we later added automated benchmarking from a third-party rate API.

Result. Average quote TAT dropped from about 24 hours to under 4.5 hours. Conversion went from 65% to 78%. Sales revenue rose by about USD 325K a month. [Say how revenue was attributed: for example, compared with the pre-launch baseline on the same lanes, controlling for seasonality.] The insight also changed the roadmap: we stopped building discount levers and invested in rate freshness and coverage instead, which led to the rate API benchmarking work.

If they push: "How do you know it was speed and not something else?" Be honest about the limits. You didn't run a clean A/B test on clients. Say what you controlled for, and what you'd do differently (for example, a staggered rollout by pod to get a cleaner comparison). Admitting the limit and naming the better design is a senior answer.

Story 2: Credit exposure (risk, finance, technical trade-off)

Situation. Silq extended trade credit to B2B clients, but finance had no live view of each client's exposure against their credit limit. Shipment activity lived in our platform, invoices and payments lived in QuickBooks, and they drifted apart. Client exposure had grown to USD 1.8M, and leadership couldn't see over-limit risk until it was already a problem.

Task. Give FinOps and leadership a reliable, live view of credit limit vs exposure, and make it usable in the booking flow, without adding friction for sales.

Action. I defined exposure as [shipped but unbilled plus invoiced but unpaid], agreed that definition with finance first because every later argument would come back to it, and designed a live sync with QuickBooks. The key design decision was reliability. Webhooks gave us real-time updates, but in testing we saw events go missing [describe how you found out]. So I added a daily change-data-capture job to reconcile and catch anything the webhooks missed. It was more engineering effort, and I had to argue for it, because finance needed to trust the number completely or they'd go back to Excel. I then worked with sales on how over-limit warnings would show up, so

reps weren't blocked blindly but knew when to call finance before booking.

Result. Client exposure fell from USD 1.8M to 1.2M within four months of launch, and credit-term compliance rose above 85%. [Add one line on adoption: for example, finance stopped maintaining their parallel sheet.] The lesson I took: in financial products, trust in the number is the product. Real-time with occasional errors is worse than slightly delayed and always right.

Story 3: LLM rate-sheet extraction (AI feature, evaluation) [complete after Week 10]

Situation. Procurement received about [N] vendor rate sheets a week in [K] different formats. Manual entry took about [T] minutes per sheet, roughly [E]% of entries had at least one error, and rates took [D] days to go live. Stale or missing rates pushed quotes into manual chase, eating into the quote TAT gains.

Task. Automate rate ingestion reliably enough that procurement would trust it, without risking live pricing.

Action. I baselined the problem first, then proposed a hybrid: rules for the three most stable vendor templates, LLM extraction for the long tail. I treated the schema as the real prompt, defined ground truth with procurement (we disagreed on [example] and wrote a rule for it), and built an eval set of [80] real sheets, including [15] deliberately ugly ones. I iterated one change at a time and logged the results: pre-processing Excel into clean tables moved accuracy from [x] to [y], and a two-pass design for surcharges moved it to [z]. Low-confidence rows and anything failing validation rules (for example a rate more than [X]% off the lane's last rate) went to a review queue. We ran shadow mode for two weeks, then assisted mode.

Result. [Field accuracy on auto-accepted rows], [review time per sheet from X to Y minutes], [cost per sheet], [reviewer override rate]. [What broke: for example, surcharges written as notes below the table, which we fixed with a second pass.] If I did it again, I'd have built the eval set before writing the first prompt, and I'd have set the review threshold per vendor rather than globally.

The follow-up they'll ask: "How did you decide it was good enough to launch?" Answer with your threshold logic: precision on auto-accepted rows had to beat the manual error rate from the baseline, with everything uncertain routed to a human. Launch didn't mean "the model is perfect". It meant "the system, including review, is better than what we had".

Story 4: Saying no to a business ask (influence, prioritisation) [live this in Weeks 3 to 10]

You don't have a clean version of this story yet, which is exactly why Part 7 Habit 3 exists. Here's the shape it should take once you've lived it:

Situation. [Sales leadership / the co-founder] asked for [feature X] by [date], because [reason].

Task. Decide whether X was the right solution to the real problem, without damaging the relationship.

Action. I wrote a one-page decision memo: the ask, the problem underneath (with [the number from the funnel]), two options including a smaller version, and what each would push back on the roadmap. I walked [stakeholder] through it and asked them to choose.

Result. We went with [the smaller version / a different solution], shipped it in [time], and [the metric] moved by [amount]. The bigger result was that [stakeholder] started bringing me problems instead of solutions.

If nothing suitable comes up at Silq in time, use a Zetwerk example where you shaped the scope of an ask from a business unit.

Story 5: Developing your APM into a PM (leadership)

Situation. When I became SPM at Silq, I had one APM reporting to me, and I was still the bottleneck on most product decisions across six modules.

Task. Grow them into someone who could own a module end to end, and free up my own time for bigger problems.

Action. [Fill in with specifics. Useful structure: which module you handed over and why that one; how you moved from reviewing their PRDs line by line to reviewing only the problem statement and success metric; one moment they got something wrong and how you handled it; how you gave them visibility with the CTO.]

Result. They were promoted to PM in [month]. [Name what they now own and one outcome of theirs.] It also changed my own job: I could spend [X] more hours a week on [discovery / the AI pilot / strategy].

Story 6: The LC module across 8 business units (cross-functional alignment)

Situation. At Zetwerk, supplier letters of credit worth about INR 240 Cr a month ran across eight business units, each with its own approval habits, mostly on email and Excel. Finance needed audit trails and control; the business units needed speed, because slow LCs delayed supplier shipments.

Task. Build one LC lifecycle module inside the OMS, integrated with MS Dynamics ERP, and get all eight BUs onto it without slowing them down.

Action. [Fill in: how you mapped the eight BU workflows; what you standardised vs allowed to vary; how you handled the BU that pushed back hardest; how you sequenced the rollout.] The Item Master work mattered here too: without clean item-level data (unit rates, HSN codes), the ERP integration would have broken.

Result. All eight BUs moved onto the module [in X weeks], with approvals, audit logs and ERP sync live, and [the approval-time outcome you confirm with old colleagues]. It contributed to the ZetStar Award for impact across inventory and core finance.

Story 7: A failure (pick your own)

Pick a real one. Good candidates: a feature that shipped but wasn't adopted, a launch that broke something, a time you trusted a stakeholder's number and it was wrong, or an estimate you missed badly. Structure: what happened, your part in it (own it, don't spread the blame), what you did in the moment, what you changed permanently. The last part is what they're really listening for. Don't pick a fake failure like "I cared too much." Interviewers spot it instantly.

Product sense questions to practise (with your angle)

Question	Angle that plays to your strengths
Design a quoting experience for SME shippers on a logistics platform	Speed beats price. Show all-in landed cost, transit certainty, and a one-click accept
Improve shipment tracking for B2B clients of a freight forwarder	The real job is "tell me before my customer asks me". Proactive exceptions over dashboards
Design a product to help procurement teams compare carrier rates	Rate freshness and normalisation are the hard part, not the UI
Design credit and payment terms for a B2B marketplace (Zetwerk, Udaan style)	Risk vs growth trade-off, exposure definitions, what sales sees at booking
Build an AI assistant for customs brokers	Where AI helps (document extraction, classification suggestions) vs where a human must sign off (liability)
Improve seller onboarding on Shiprocket or a similar platform	Activation metric, first shipment as the aha moment

Metrics and RCA questions

Question	What they're testing
Quote-to-book conversion dropped 15% week on week. Diagnose	Segmenting by lane, mode, rep, client; checking data issues first; rate staleness as a hypothesis
What's the north star for a freight forwarding platform?	You'll be tempted to say revenue. Talk about won shipments or gross profit, with inputs and guardrails (Part 7 metric tree)
Define success for an LLM document extraction feature	Field accuracy, review time, override rate, cost, and a business outcome
Tracking page logins went up 30% after a launch. Good or bad?	Could be bad: people checking more because ETAs are unreliable. Look at support tickets alongside

Strategy questions

Question	A strong position to start from
Should a freight forwarder build its own software or buy a TMS?	Build where it's your edge (pricing, client experience), buy commodity (accounting, basic TMS)
Where will AI create durable advantage in logistics?	Your Project 4 thesis: exceptions and workflow data, not quoting
How would you grow a logistics SaaS into mid-market enterprises?	Integration depth, ERP connectors, and credit and finance features as the wedge
A competitor launched instant quotes. Respond	Instant only matters if it's accurate and all-in. Compete on reliability and total landed cost

AI PM question bank with answer sketches

Question	Answer sketch
How do you evaluate an LLM feature before launch?	Golden set with hard cases, task-specific metrics, human-labelled ground truth, LLM judge checked against humans, regression suite. Use your co-pilot and rate-sheet numbers
And after launch?	Online signals: override rate, edits, complaints, sampled human review weekly, drift alerts on template or model changes
When would you not use an LLM?	When rules are stable and cheap (your top 3 vendor templates), when errors are unacceptable without review, when latency or cost kill the unit economics
How do you handle hallucinations in a high-stakes workflow?	Constrain outputs to a schema, require evidence (source cell), validate deterministically, route uncertainty to humans, design the UI so correction is easy
RAG vs fine-tuning vs long context?	Your co-pilot design decision. Few examples plus a changing corpus favours RAG; fine-tuning for format and style at scale; long context when the corpus is small and retrieval is the failure point
Agent or workflow?	Workflow first when steps are known (RFQ to quote). Agents when paths genuinely vary, and only with checkpoints. Use the Block 5 design doc
How do you think about AI feature cost?	Tokens per task, model tiering, caching, batch vs real time; cost per sheet vs minutes saved per sheet
How do you build user trust in an AI feature?	Shadow mode, then assisted, then autonomous. Show confidence. Make errors cheap to fix. Never surprise users with a silent failure

Self-evaluation rubric (score every mock out of 5 on each)

Dimension	1	3	5
Structure	Listener gets lost	Clear sections, some wandering	Signposted, easy to follow, time-boxed
Depth	Surface-level everywhere	Goes deep in one place	Goes deep with trade-offs and second-order effects
Judgment	No clear choice	Makes a choice, weak reasoning	Clear choice, defends it, names what was given up
Specificity	Generic examples	Some real examples	Real numbers, real domain detail, your own stories
Time	Over 20 min or under 5	15 to 18 min	12 to 15 min, with time for follow-ups

Peer mocks and the mistake log

- **Pair up** with one person from the Ayuda community who is also targeting Senior PM. Meet weekly from Week 5. Take turns: one interviews, one answers, then swap. Score each other with the rubric above. Give one thing to keep and one thing to fix. No more than that.
- **Keep a mistake log** from your first real interview. Columns: date, company, round, question, what I said, what I should have said, pattern. After every five entries, look for the pattern. Most people discover they have one or two repeat mistakes (for many senior PMs it's jumping to solutions, or not stating a clear recommendation). Fix the pattern, not the individual answer.

Part 12. Applications and outreach

Where to apply, how many, and exactly what to send

Cadence

Weeks	Applications per week	Outreach per week	Mix	CV version
5 to 7	3 to 4	3 to 5	Tier 3 and Tier 2 only. You're calibrating	SPM
8 to 12	6 to 8	5	All tiers. Add Archetype D from Week 9	SPM, plus AI PM for D
13 to 14	2 to 3	Prep only	Holiday lull	Both
15 to 16	8	5	All tiers, January budgets	Both

That's roughly 70 applications over 12 weeks. For someone working full time, quality beats volume past that point. If you're getting callbacks, don't increase volume. Put the time into company prep instead.

The application routine (25 minutes per application)

1. **Five minutes:** read the JD twice. Highlight the three things they care about most.
2. **Ten minutes:** run the JD through Atlas to get the keyword and skill gaps, and a tailored CV draft. Then check it by hand: keep your domain words, remove anything Atlas invented, and move the bullet that best matches their top need to position one or two.
3. **Five minutes:** find the hiring manager or a PM on the team. Send the outreach message (templates below).
4. **Five minutes:** log it in the tracker: date, company, tier, role, CV version, outreach sent, status.

Outreach templates

Rules for every message: under 100 words, reference their product first, one line of proof, a small ask. Never open with "I'm looking for a PM role."

Template 1: hiring manager at a logistics tech company

> Hi [Name], I've been following [Company]'s [specific launch, e.g. new rate management module]. At Silq, a US freight forwarder, I own the quoting and rates stack; we cut quote turnaround from 24 hours to under 4.5 and found speed mattered more than price for win rate. I'm curious whether you see the same pattern with your shippers. I've applied for the [Role] opening and would value 15 minutes to hear how your team thinks about [the problem]. Either way, great work on [launch].

Template 2: founder or product lead at a vertical AI company

> Hi [Name], [Company]'s approach to [document extraction / freight ops automation] caught my eye, especially [specific detail]. I've been working on the same problem from the inside: I'm shipping LLM extraction for vendor rate sheets at a US forwarder, and the hardest part has been defining ground truth for surcharges, not the model. Happy to share what I've learned. I'm also exploring AI PM roles and [Company] is top of my list. Open to a short chat?

Template 3: PM at a mature platform (for a referral, after you've engaged with their posts)

> Hi [Name], thanks for your post on [topic]; the point about [detail] matched what I've seen integrating ERP data at Zetwerk and Silq. I'm a Senior PM in freight and B2B finance systems and I'm exploring roles on [Dynamics 365 SCM / their product area]. Would you be open to 15 minutes so I can understand what the team values? If it seems like a fit after that, I'd be grateful for a referral, but no pressure at all.

Template 4: follow-up (5 to 7 days later, once only)

> Hi [Name], a quick follow-up on my note last week. I recently published [a short write-up on evaluating AI for freight documents / a teardown of shipper quoting flows], which touches on [their area]: [link]. Would still value 15 minutes if you have it.

> **The follow-up with a new artifact is the one that gets replies.** It shows you're doing the work, not just asking. This is why the projects are timed to publish through Weeks 5 to 13.

Referrals

The Indian market is heavily referral-driven, especially for Senior roles. Three sources:

1. **Ex-Zetwerk colleagues.** Zetwerk alumni are spread across Indian B2B, manufacturing and supply chain startups. Go through your connections this week and list everyone who's moved on. Reconnect with no ask first.
2. **The Ayuda community and alumni.** Help others first: review someone's CV, share a lead that isn't right for you. Then ask.
3. **People you meet through outreach.** A good 15-minute conversation often turns into a referral if you ask at the end: "Would you be comfortable referring me, or is there someone else on the team I should talk to?"

When callbacks are low: debug the funnel

After 15 applications, check this table. Don't guess, look at your tracker.

Symptom	Likely cause	Fix
Under 10% callback rate overall	CV positioning or targeting	Compare the JD's top three needs with your CV's top three bullets. Are you applying to Archetype C or E too early?

Symptom	Likely cause	Fix
Callbacks from Tier 3 but not Tier 1 or 2	Level or brand mismatch	Get referrals for Tier 1 and 2. Cold applications rarely convert there
Good callback rate, drop after HM screen	Story or motivation	Rehearse "why leaving", "why us", and the 30-second pitch. Record and review
Drop after product sense or case rounds	Structure or depth	More peer mocks with the rubric. Check the mistake log for the pattern
Drop in final rounds	Senior signals missing	Strengthen Stories 4 and 5 (influence and leadership). Ask for feedback from the recruiter every time

Handling offers (for Weeks 12 to 16 and beyond)

- **Know your notice period** and whether Silq allows a buyout. Many Indian employers ask for this upfront. Check your contract now so you're not surprised.
- **Level first, then money.** If an offer levels you as PM, ask what it takes to reach Senior within 12 to 18 months, and get that written into your first-year goals. That's worth more than a small pay bump.
- **Never accept on the call.** Thank them, ask for the written offer, and ask for three to five working days.
- **Use a competing offer carefully.** Tell other active processes you have an offer and ask whether they can move faster. Don't bluff.
- **Send me the offer before you sign.** I'm happy to go through it with you. This is outside the three formal reviews, and it's fine.

Part 13. Rhythm, tracker, and what I review

Keep this part open every week

Your weekly rhythm (working full time)

When	What	Time
Monday morning, at work	Funnel note: three lines on what moved at Silq (Part 7)	20 min
Weekday mornings, before work (3 days)	Applications and outreach, or AI learning reading	30 to 40 min
Weekday evenings (2 evenings)	Proof of work: eval runs, write-ups, Figma, memo	1 to 1.5 hrs
One weekday evening	Peer mock or mock recording	1 hr
Saturday	Ayuda live session (learning or AI), then 2 hrs of project work	3 to 4 hrs
Sunday	Ayuda interview prep session or self-practice. Plan next week from Part 10. Schedule the LinkedIn post	2 hrs
Any evening	LinkedIn post (write in 20 minutes, don't overthink it)	20 min

That's around 9 to 11 hours a week outside work. If a week at Silq explodes (and in freight, some will), protect three things only: the Monday funnel note, the Silq AI pilot, and one application block. Everything else can slide by a week.

Progress tracker

Score yourself every four weeks. Be honest. The point is to spot drift early.

Metric	By Week 4	By Week 8	By Week 12	By Week 16
Repos fixed and safe	Done			
CV v1 reviewed by me, placeholders removed	Done			
Rate-ingestion pilot	Pitched, PRD done	Shadow mode live	Result note written	Outcome bullet on CV
Internal user interviews	4	8 plus synthesis		
Decision memos written	1	2	3	4
Quote funnel notes (weekly)	2	6	10	14
Projects published	0	2	3	4
LinkedIn posts	2	6	10	14

Metric	By Week 4	By Week 8	By Week 12	By Week 16
Applications (cumulative)	0	12	40	70
Outreach messages (cumulative)	0	15	35	55
Peer mocks (cumulative)	1	5	11	16
Active processes	0	1 to 2	3 to 5	Offer stage

What I review (exactly three things)

> **I review exactly three things:**
>
> - **CV v1:** end of Week 2, after you've replaced or removed every placeholder number. One round of feedback. You revise, then you apply.
> - **AI capstone write-up:** end of Week 10. The one-pager on rate-sheet extraction (or the synthetic fallback). I'm reviewing the product thinking and the evaluation, not the code.
> - **Your first two mock answers:** end of Week 4. One product sense and one metrics or AI answer, recorded or written. Calibration feedback. After that, peer mocks carry it.
>
> Everything else is self-serve: the weekend live sessions, peer mocks, the community group, hackathons. Bring specific questions to the live sessions. If something is genuinely blocking you, message me, but try the community first.

A last word

On the call you asked whether you'll have "enough on your experience belt" for the companies you want. You will, but not because of more courses. You'll get there because for the next 16 weeks you'll do three things most PMs never do: measure what you ship after launch, put AI into a real workflow and prove it works, and write down your decisions as decisions.

You already built a quotation engine that proved speed beats price. Apply the same insight to your own search. A good move made in January with strong stories beats a perfect move you're still preparing for in June.

Start with Week 1. Fix the repos first.

Malay